

Chapter 6 — SUPPLEMENT: Peasants and Farmers · Clothing: A Social History

Why this file exists: NCERT moved **three chapters out of the printed Class IX book** into "extended learning" behind a QR code. Two of them are worth more to you than several of the chapters that survived. **Peasants and Farmers** is the only place in the entire NCERT History series where you meet the **English enclosures**, the **American Dust Bowl** and the **opium trade with China** — all three named or implied in the GS1 World History syllabus. **Clothing: A Social History** is the only place you meet **sumptuary laws**, the **Shanar (Nadar) revolt**, the **shoe-respect controversy**, and the full arc of **Gandhi's clothing as political argument**.

This is the same call we made for **Class 7**, where NCERT deleted *Rulers and Buildings* and *Towns, Traders and Craftspersons* and we wrote them back in. **Rationalisation is a school-workload decision, not a UPSC-relevance decision.**

← Ch.5 | Index

 **Source:** written from the **pre-rationalisation 8-chapter edition**, recovered from archive.org and stored at `../Textbook_PDF/Removed_Chapters_Old_Edition/` — see the README there for how it was found and its OCR caveats.  **The third removed chapter, *History and Sport: The Story of Cricket*, is not written up here.** It is a genuinely good chapter on colonial sport and social hierarchy, but its UPSC yield is an occasional essay hook, not exam content. The PDF is in the same folder if you ever want it.

Syllabus Classification

Field	PART A — Peasants and Farmers	PART B — Clothing: A Social History
Subject	World History + Modern India	Social & cultural history — World + Modern India
Sub-discipline	Agrarian history · ecological history · trade	History of everyday life · caste · nationalism
Period	c. 1650 – 1930s	c. 1294 – 1947
Prelims	★★★★ Captain Swing, enclosure figures, McCormick's reaper, the Dust Bowl, opium chest figures, Lin Ze-xu, the triangular trade	★★★★ Sumptuary laws, bloomers, the Shanar revolt and its two proclamations, the Brahmika sari, the Gandhi cap
Mains GS1	★★★★★ "industrial revolution... colonization... effect on the society"; agrarian transformation; the Opium Wars are a set-piece of 19th-century world history	★★★★★ Social reform, caste and dignity , the Swadeshi movement , Gandhi's method
Also feeds	GS3 Environment ★★★★★ (the Dust Bowl is the classic case of an ecological catastrophe manufactured by agricultural policy), GS3 Agriculture ★★★★★ (mechanisation, monoculture, farm debt), Economy ★★ (trade deficits, bullion, commodity booms and busts), Essay ★★★★★	Indian Society ★★★★★ (caste, gender, dignity, dress as identity), Ethics ★★★★★ (symbolic leadership; Gandhi's "anything I may not be prepared to follow"), Essay ★★★★★
Weightage	★★★★★	★★★★
Overlaps with	Ch.4 & Ch.5 of this book (commons, "waste", ecological limits), Class 8 Ch.3 (indigo — the same advance-and-contract system as opium)	Ch.1 of this book (<i>sans-culottes</i>), Ch.3 (uniforms and identity), Class 8 Ch.7 (Women, Caste and Reform), Class 8 Ch.8 (Swadeshi, Non-Cooperation)

Learning Outcomes

Part A — Peasants and Farmers

- ☐ **Explain the open-field and commons system**, and what the commons meant *to the poor specifically*. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Distinguish the sixteenth-century enclosures from those after 1750** — different purpose, different backer. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain why enclosure accelerated after 1750**, with the population and price figures. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain how England fed a quadrupling population without a technological revolution**. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Say who Captain Swing was and what the riots were about**, with the punishment figures. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Narrate the westward move in the USA** and its cost to Native Americans. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain the machinery**, and why the *same* machines made big farmers rich and small farmers destitute. ★★★★★
- ☐ ★★★★★ **Explain the Dust Bowl as a man-made disaster** — and state what drought alone could not have done.
- ☐ **Explain the tea–silver–opium triangle** and why Britain needed opium at all. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Give the FOUR reasons Indian peasants did not want to grow poppy**. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain the system of advances** and where the government's opium revenue actually came from. ★★★★★

Part B — Clothing

- ☐ **Define sumptuary laws** and give both of their purposes. ★★★★★
 - ☐ **Explain how the French Revolution changed dress**, and what replaced sumptuary law. ★★★★★
 - ☐ **Explain the Victorian corset** as an argument about womanhood, and how women divided over it. ★★★★★
 - ☐ **Name the dress-reform figures and organisations** on both sides of the Atlantic. ★★★★★
 - ☐ **Explain what the two World Wars did to women's clothing**. ★★★★★
 - ☐ **State the THREE Indian reactions to Western dress**. ★★★★★
 - ☐ ★★★★★ **Narrate the Shanar (Nadar) revolt, 1822–1859**, with both proclamations.
 - ☐ **Explain the turban/hat and shoe-respect conflicts**, and the 1862 Surat case. ★★★★★
 - ☐ **Explain the search for a national dress** — the Tagores, the *chapkan*, the Brahmi sari, and why it failed. ★★★★★
 - ☐ **Trace Gandhi's dress from 1888 to 1921** and explain each change as an argument. ★★★★★
 - ☐ ★★★★★ **Explain why khadi could NOT unite the nation** — the poverty objection and the Ambedkar objection.
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PART A — PEASANTS AND FARMERS

The chapter's own framing: "You will find out about the **small cottagers in England**, the **wheat farmers of the USA**, and the **opium producers of Bengal**. You will see what happens to different rural groups with the coming of **modern agriculture**; what happens when **different regions of the world are integrated with the capitalist world market**. By comparing the histories of different places you will see **how these histories are different, even though some of the processes are similar**."

THREE COUNTRIES, ONE QUESTION:

what happens to rural people when their land is joined to a world market?

ENGLAND	the commons are ENCLOSED	-> the poor lose their customary rights
USA	the grasslands are PLOUGHED	-> the soil itself blows away
INDIA	the peasant is ADVANCED money	-> he loses the right to choose his crop

1 England — The Coming of Modern Agriculture

🔥 **Start here: Captain Swing, 1830**

Date	Event
★ 1 June 1830	A farmer in the north-west of England finds his barn and haystack reduced to ashes by a fire started at night. In the months that follow, such fires are reported from numerous districts — sometimes only the rick, sometimes the entire farmhouse
★★ 28 August 1830	A threshing machine is destroyed by labourers in East Kent
The two years after	Riots spread over southern England ; ★★ about 387 threshing machines were broken
★★★ The letters	Farmers received threatening letters urging them to stop using machines that deprived workmen of their livelihood . Most were signed in the name of ★ "Captain Swing" — " <i>a mythic name</i> ", not a real person
The effect	*** Alarmed landlords feared attacks by armed bands at night, and many destroyed their own machines. ***
★★★ The punishment	***Government action was severe... 1,976 prisoners were tried, NINE MEN WERE HANGED, 505 TRANSPORTED — over 450 of them to AUSTRALIA — and 644 put behind bars. ***

The two letters NCERT prints — note the range of tone: (mild) — "Sir, This is to acquaint you that *if your threshing machines are not destroyed by you directly we shall commence our labours*. Signed on behalf of the whole — *Swing*" (severe) — "Sir, *Your name is down amongst the Black hearts in the Black Book* and this is to advise you and the like of you... *to make your wills*. Ye have been the *Blackguard Enemies of the people* on all occasions... *Swing*"

🎯 ★★ ★★ **Why the name matters, and this is a good answer point:** "Captain Swing" was **nobody**. Using a shared invented name meant **the movement had no leader to arrest** — and it meant every farmer receiving a letter had to assume a whole countryside was behind it. **An anonymous collective signature is a weapon of the powerless**, and you will meet the same device again in the **mango boughs and chillies of Bastar** (Ch.4) — messages with no signatory that no one could trace.

1.1 The time of open fields and commons

BEFORE ENCLOSURE – the English countryside was OPEN
"It was NOT partitioned into enclosed lands privately owned by landlords."

THE ARABLE

Peasants cultivated on STRIPS of land around the village.

"At the beginning of each year, AT A PUBLIC MEETING, each villager was allocated a number of strips to cultivate."

"Usually, these strips were of VARYING QUALITY and often located in DIFFERENT PLACES, NOT NEXT TO EACH OTHER.

THE EFFORT WAS TO ENSURE THAT EVERYONE HAD A MIX OF GOOD AND BAD LAND."

BEYOND THE STRIPS – THE COMMON LAND

"ALL villagers had access to the commons." Here they:

- pastured their COWS and grazed their SHEEP
- collected FUELWOOD for fire
- gathered BERRIES AND FRUIT for food
- FISHED in the rivers and ponds
- HUNTED RABBIT in common forests

"FOR THE POOR, THE COMMON LAND WAS ESSENTIAL FOR SURVIVAL. It SUPPLEMENTED THEIR MEAGRE INCOME, SUSTAINED THEIR CATTLE, and HELPED THEM TIDE OVER BAD TIMES WHEN CROPS FAILED."

★★★★ Read the strip-allocation rule again, because it is doing something clever. Strips were deliberately **scattered and of mixed quality**, redistributed **annually at a public meeting**. That is **not** inefficiency — it is a **risk-pooling device**. If hail flattens one corner of the parish, no single family is wiped out, because nobody's holding is all in one place. **The system optimised for survival, not for yield**; enclosure optimised for yield, and moved the risk onto the individual.  **Set this beside Bastar's village boundaries and grain-paid watchmen (Ch.4) and the pastoral rotation (Ch.5).** Three commons regimes in one book, all of them governed, all of them dismantled as disorder.

The sixteenth-century enclosures — for WOOL

Trigger	"When the price of wool went up in the world market in the sixteenth century , rich farmers wanted to expand wool production to earn profits "
What they wanted	To improve their sheep breeds and ensure good feed; therefore to control large areas of land in compact blocks to allow improved breeding
What they did	"began dividing and enclosing common land and building hedges around their holdings to separate their property from that of others"; ★ "drove out villagers who had small cottages on the commons, and prevented the poor from entering the enclosed fields "
★★★★ Who backed them	"Till the middle of the eighteenth century the enclosure movement proceeded very slowly . The early enclosures were usually created by individual landlords . THEY WERE NOT SUPPORTED BY THE STATE OR THE CHURCH. "

1.2 The post-1750 enclosures — for GRAIN

★★★★ The distinction NCERT wants you to make: *"The new enclosures were **different from the old**. Unlike the sixteenth-century enclosures that promoted **SHEEP FARMING**, the land being enclosed in the late eighteenth century was for **GRAIN PRODUCTION**."*

And this time the state joined in:

☆☆☆ **""After the mid-eighteenth century... the enclosure movement **swept through the countryside, changing the English landscape for ever. Between 1750 and 1850, 6 MILLION ACRES of land was enclosed. The British Parliament no longer watched this process from a distance. IT PASSED 4,000 ACTS LEGALISING THESE ENCLOSURES.**""**

Why the demand for grain exploded:

Driver	Detail
☆☆☆ Population	"Between 1750 and 1900 it multiplied over four times , mounting from 7 million in 1750 to 21 million in 1850 and 30 million in 1900 "
Urbanisation	"Britain at this time was industrialising . More and more people began to live and work in urban areas . Men from rural areas migrated to towns in search of jobs. To survive they had to BUY foodgrains in the market "
The market	"As the urban population grew, the market for foodgrains expanded , and when demand increased rapidly, foodgrain prices rose "
☆☆ The war	"By the end of the eighteenth century, France was at war with England. This disrupted trade and the import of foodgrains from Europe. Prices of foodgrains in England SKYROCKETED , encouraging landowners to enclose lands and enlarge the area under grain cultivation"
☆☆ The politics	""Profits flowed in and landowners PRESSURISED THE PARLIAMENT to pass the Enclosure Acts.""

🔗 **Note the causal loop, it makes a tidy paragraph:** war raises prices → high prices make enclosure profitable → profits give landowners political weight → they use it to get Parliament to legalise more enclosure → more grain. **The Enclosure Acts were not a policy imposed on landowners; they were a policy purchased by them.**

1.3 The age of enclosures — the thing that had never happened before

☆☆☆☆ **""There is **one dramatic fact** that makes the period after the **1780s** different from any earlier period in English history. **In earlier times, rapid population growth was most often followed by a period of FOOD SHORTAGES. Food-grain production in the past had not expanded as rapidly as the population. IN THE NINETEENTH CENTURY THIS DID NOT HAPPEN IN ENGLAND. GRAIN PRODUCTION GREW AS QUICKLY AS POPULATION.**""**

☆☆ **""Even though the population increased rapidly, **in 1868 England was producing about 80 PER CENT of the food it consumed. The rest was imported.**""**

And here is the point that surprises people:

☆☆☆☆ **"This increase in food-grain production was made possible **NOT BY ANY RADICAL INNOVATIONS IN AGRICULTURAL TECHNOLOGY**, but by **BRINGING NEW LANDS UNDER CULTIVATION**. Landlords **sliced up pasturelands, carved up open fields, cut up forest commons, took over marshes**, and turned larger and larger areas into agricultural fields."**

What technology there was, was old and simple — the turnip-and-clover story:

From about the 1660s, farmers in many parts of England began growing TURNIP and CLOVER.

They discovered these crops IMPROVED THE SOIL and made it MORE FERTILE. Turnip was also A GOOD FODDER CROP RELISHED BY CATTLE. So farmers cultivated them regularly, and they BECAME PART OF THE CROPPING SYSTEM.

"LATER FINDINGS SHOWED that these crops had the capacity to INCREASE THE NITROGEN CONTENT OF THE SOIL."

Nitrogen was important for crop growth. Cultivating the same soil over a few years DEPLETED the nitrogen and reduced fertility. By RESTORING nitrogen, turnip and clover made the soil fertile once again.

★ ★ ★ The nicest detail in the chapter, and a genuine insight about how knowledge works: farmers adopted turnip and clover **from the 1660s because they observed that it worked**. The *reason* — nitrogen fixation — was discovered **much later**. **Practice ran ahead of theory by two centuries**. Keep this for any essay on traditional knowledge versus scientific validation; it is the exact counterpart of the argument in Ch.4 about "scientific" forestry, where the theory ran ahead of the practice and got it wrong.

So the case for enclosure was: *"Enclosures were now seen as **necessary to make long-term investments on land and plan crop rotations to improve the soil**. Enclosures also allowed the **richer landowners to expand the land under their control and produce more for the market**."*

💔 1.4 What happened to the poor?

★ ★ ★ ***"Enclosures filled the pockets of landlords. But what happened to those who depended on the commons for their survival? When fences came up, the enclosed land became the exclusive property of ONE landowner."***

THE POOR COULD NO LONGER:

- collect their FIREWOOD from the forests
- graze their CATTLE on the commons
- collect APPLES AND BERRIES
- hunt SMALL ANIMALS for meat
- GLEAN -- "gather the stalks that lay on the fields after the crops were cut"

"EVERYTHING BELONGED TO THE LANDLORDS, EVERYTHING HAD A PRICE WHICH THE POOR COULD NOT AFFORD TO PAY."

Where they went, and what they found:

- Where enclosures were extensive — ★ **particularly the Midlands and the counties around** — *"the poor were **displaced** from the land. They found their **customary rights gradually disappearing**. Deprived of their rights and driven off the land, **they tramped in search of work**."*
- **"From the Midlands, they moved to the **southern counties** of England... **most intensively cultivated**, and there was a **great demand for agricultural labourers**. But nowhere could the poor find secure jobs."**

And the collapse of the old employment relationship — ★ ★ ★ this is the part worth learning:

"Earlier, it was common for labourers to LIVE WITH LANDOWNERS. They ATE AT THE MASTER'S TABLE, and helped their master THROUGH THE YEAR, doing a variety of odd jobs. By 1800 this practice was disappearing. Labourers were being paid wages and employed ONLY DURING HARVEST TIME. As landowners tried to increase their profits, they cut the amount they had to spend on their workmen. WORK BECAME INSECURE, EMPLOYMENT UNCERTAIN, INCOME UNSTABLE. For a very large part of the year the poor had NO WORK."

★★★★ This is the deepest change in the chapter and it is not about land at all. A year-round relationship of maintenance — board, lodging, odd jobs, the master's table — was replaced by a seasonal cash transaction. The labourer became cheaper and freer at the same time, and the risk of the idle months moved from the employer to him. That is what "modern" means here, and it is precisely why the poor did not experience agricultural improvement as improvement.

NCERT's question about women and children, worth answering: *"Cow keeping, collection of firewood, gleaning, gathering of fruits and berries from the common lands was earlier MOSTLY DONE BY WOMEN AND CHILDREN."* — So enclosure destroyed the specifically female and child contribution to household income first. A household that had run on the man's labour plus the commons now ran on the man's wage alone, and only in season. Enclosure did not merely impoverish families; it made women and children economically dependent within them.

✂ The two sides of the argument — ★★★★★ learn both, NCERT asks you to weigh them

★ SOURCE C — a peasant who lost his rights, writing to the local lord	★ SOURCE D — John Middleton, an 18th-century writer
"Should a poor man take one of your sheep from the common, his life would be forfeited by law. But should You take the common from a hundred poor men's sheep, the law gives no redress. The poor man is liable to be hung for taking from You <i>what would not supply you with a meal</i> ; & You would do nothing illegal by depriving him of his subsistence... What should be the inference of the poor... when the laws are not accessible to the injured poor and the government gives them no redress?"	"There can be no question of the superior profit to the farmer of enclosures rather than open fields . In one case he is in chains ; he can make no changes in soil or prices , he is like a horse in team , he must jog along with the rest ."
The argument: the law is not neutral — the same act is theft when done by the poor and property when done by the rich	The argument: the open-field system immobilises the improving farmer , who cannot innovate because he is tied to collective decisions

🎯 Both are right about different things, and saying so is how you write this answer. Middleton is correct that **collective decision-making blocks individual innovation** — the annual reallocation of strips gives nobody an incentive to invest in a plot they may not have next year. The peasant is correct that **the gain was captured by one party and the loss imposed on another** who had no legal standing. **The productivity case for enclosure and the justice case against it are not in contradiction; they are answers to different questions.** England got its grain *and* its dispossessed.

⚙️ 1.5 Threshing machines and the road to the riots

DURING THE NAPOLEONIC WARS

Foodgrain prices HIGH → farmers expanded production vigorously. FEARING A SHORTAGE OF LABOUR they began buying the new THRESHING MACHINES.

Their stated complaints: "the INSOLENT of labourers, their DRINKING HABITS, and the DIFFICULTY OF MAKING THEM WORK." The machines "would help them REDUCE THEIR DEPENDENCE ON LABOURERS."

AFTER THE WARS ENDED

"Thousands of SOLDIERS RETURNED to the villages" needing alternative jobs.

At the same time "GRAIN FROM EUROPE began flowing into England, PRICES DECLINED, and an AGRICULTURAL DEPRESSION set in."

ANXIOUS LANDOWNERS

- REDUCED the area they cultivated
- DEMANDED that imports of crops be STOPPED
- tried to CUT WAGES and the NUMBER OF WORKMEN

"The unemployed poor TRAMPED FROM VILLAGE TO VILLAGE, and those with uncertain jobs LIVED IN FEAR of a loss of their livelihood."

THE CAPTAIN SWING RIOTS

"For the poor THE THRESHING MACHINES HAD BECOME A SIGN OF BAD TIMES."

★★★★ The last sentence is the analytical key, and it saves you from a lazy answer. The rioters were **not** ignorant machine-haters. They broke machines because the machine was **the visible object at the centre of an invisible squeeze** — war boom, then peace, then returning soldiers, then cheap European grain, then falling prices, then wage cuts. **You cannot smash a price index.** Machine-breaking is what protest looks like when the real cause has no address.

🇬🇧 England — the conclusion

*"The **open fields disappeared**, and the **customary rights of peasants were undermined**. The **richer farmers expanded grain production, sold this grain in the world market, made profits, and became powerful**. The **poor left their villages in large numbers** — some from the Midlands to the Southern counties where jobs were available, **others to the cities**. The **income of labourers became unstable, their jobs insecure, their livelihood precarious**."*

2 The USA — Bread Basket and Dust Bowl

🌲 What was there before

Fact	Figure
★★ Forests, at the end of the 18th century	over 800 million acres
★★ Grasslands	600 million acres
★ Eventually cleared for agricultural settlement	"about HALF the forest cover and ONE THIRD of the grasslands "
White settlement till the 1780s	"confined to a small narrow strip of coastal land in the east "

And who was actually there: "Several of them were **nomadic**, some were **settled**. Many lived only by **hunting, gathering and fishing**; others cultivated **corn, beans, tobacco and pumpkin**. Still others were **expert trappers** through whom **European traders had secured their supplies of BEAVER FUR since the sixteenth century.**"

🔗 ★★ ★ **Note that last group and cross-link it to Ch.4.** The Native American trappers are the same story as the **Mundurucu** collecting rubber and the **adivasis trading through Banjaras** — communities drawn into a world market as **suppliers of a raw commodity**, long before they were dispossessed. **Integration came before conquest.**

🐎 2.1 The westward move

1775-1783 THE AMERICAN WAR OF INDEPENDENCE, and the formation of the United States
|
BY 1800 When THOMAS JEFFERSON became President,
OVER 700,000 WHITE SETTLERS had moved on to
the APPALACHIAN PLATEAU through the passes.
|
THE PROMISE, seen from the east coast:
- "its WILDERNESS could be turned into CULTIVATED FIELDS"
- "FOREST TIMBER could be cut for EXPORT"
- "ANIMALS hunted for SKIN"
- "MOUNTAINS MINED for GOLD AND MINERALS"
|
"BUT THIS MEANT THAT THE AMERICAN INDIANS HAD TO BE
CLEARED FROM THE LAND."
"In the decades after 1800 the US government COMMITTED
ITSELF TO A POLICY OF DRIVING THE AMERICAN INDIANS WESTWARD,
first BEYOND THE RIVER MISSISSIPPI, and then FURTHER WEST.
NUMEROUS WARS WERE WAGED IN WHICH INDIANS WERE MASSACRED
AND MANY OF THEIR VILLAGES BURNT. The Indians RESISTED, WON
MANY VICTORIES in wars, but were ULTIMATELY FORCED TO SIGN
TREATIES, GIVE UP THEIR LAND AND MOVE WESTWARD."
|
THE WAVES OF SETTLEMENT
- APPALACHIAN PLATEAU by the first decade of the 1800s
- MISSISSIPPI VALLEY between 1820 and 1850
- THE GREAT PLAINS across the Mississippi -- only
AFTER THE 1860s. "In subsequent decades this region
became a MAJOR WHEAT-PRODUCING AREA of America."
|
THE METHOD: "They SLASHED AND BURNT forests, PULLED OUT THE
STUMPS, cleared the land, and built LOG CABINS in the forest
clearings. Then they cleared larger areas, and ERECTED FENCES
around the fields. They PLOUGHED the land and sowed CORN AND
WHEAT."
"When the soil became IMPOVERISHED AND EXHAUSTED in one
place, the migrants would MOVE FURTHER WEST."

★★★★ **Mark that last line — it is the seed of section 2.5.** The settlers' answer to exhausted soil was **not to restore it but to abandon it and move on**. That works as long as there is a further west. **The Dust Bowl is what happens when the frontier runs out and the method does not change.**

2.2 The wheat farmers

Driver	Detail
Demand	"The urban population in the USA was growing and the export market was becoming ever bigger . As the demand increased, wheat prices rose "
★ Transport	"The spread of the railways made it easy to transport the grain from the wheat-growing regions to the eastern coast for export "
★★★ The war	*"during the First World War the world market boomed . Russian supplies of wheat were cut off and the USA had to feed Europe . US President Wilson called upon farmers to respond: ★ 'Plant more wheat, wheat will win the war.'"*
★★★ The expansion	1910: about 45 million acres under wheat → nine years later (1919): 74 million acres — "an increase of about 65 per cent ". Most of it in the Great Plains
★★ The wheat barons	"big farmers... controlled as much as 2,000 to 3,000 acres of land individually "

 **Cross-link to Ch.2 of this book:** *Russian supplies of wheat were cut off*. Why? Because Russia was **collapsing into revolution** (Ch.2 §2.5: grain sent to the army, railways breaking down, bread riots by the winter of 1916). **The American wheat boom and the Russian bread riots are the same event seen from two ends of a supply chain.** That connection is worth making explicitly in a world-history answer — it is exactly what "an integrated world market" means.

2.3 The new technology

Problem	Solution
The prairie sod	"The prairie was covered with a thick mat of grass with tough roots ." To break the sod, ★ "a variety of new ploughs were devised locally, some of them 12 FEET LONG . Their front rested on small wheels and they were hitched on to SIX YOKES of oxen or horses "
By the early 20th century	"farmers in the Great Plains were breaking the ground with TRACTORS and DISK PLOUGHS "
Harvesting before the 1830s	"the grain used to be harvested with a CRADLE or SICKLE . At harvest time, hundreds of men and women could be seen in the fields cutting the crop"
★★★ 1831	CYRUS McCORMICK invented the first mechanical REAPER , "which could cut in one day as much as FIVE MEN could cut with cradles and SIXTEEN MEN with sickles "
★★ By the early 20th century	combined harvesters — "With one of these machines, 500 acres of wheat could be harvested in TWO WEEKS "
★★★ The bottom line	"With power-driven machinery, FOUR MEN could plough, seed and harvest 2,000 to 4,000 ACRES of wheat in a season "

2.4 What happened to the poor?

★★★★★ *"For the poorer farmers, machines brought misery. Many of them **bought these machines**, imagining that wheat prices would remain high and profits would flow in. If they had no money, **THE BANKS OFFERED LOANS**. Those who borrowed **found it difficult to pay back their debts**. Many of them **DESERTED THEIR FARMS** and looked for jobs elsewhere."*

*"But jobs were difficult to find. **MECHANISATION HAD REDUCED THE NEED FOR LABOUR.**"*

And then the market turned:

The boom "seemed to have come to an end BY THE MID-1920s."

"Production had expanded SO RAPIDLY during the war and post-war years that there was A LARGE SURPLUS."

"UNSOLD STOCKS PILED UP, STOREHOUSES OVERFLOWED WITH GRAIN, and VAST AMOUNTS OF CORN AND WHEAT WERE TURNED INTO ANIMAL FEED."

"WHEAT PRICES FELL and EXPORT MARKETS COLLAPSED."

=> "THE GREAT AGRARIAN DEPRESSION OF THE 1930s THAT RUINED WHEAT FARMERS EVERYWHERE."

★★★★ The trap the small farmer fell into is worth spelling out, because it recurs in Indian agriculture to this day. The machine was **only affordable on credit**, and **only repayable at high prices**. So the small farmer took on a **fixed liability** against a **variable income** — and the machine that was supposed to save him **also destroyed the wage labour he could have fallen back on**. High prices made the debt look sane; the moment prices fell, the same machine that made the big farmer efficient made the small farmer bankrupt. ★ **The same technology is a ladder or a trap depending on the scale you already have** — that sentence answers "advantages and disadvantages of mechanical harvesting" on its own.

🍷 2.5 The Dust Bowl — ★★★★★ the single most valuable passage in this supplement
What happened:

"In the 1930s, terrifying duststorms began to blow over the SOUTHERN PLAINS. ★★ BLACK BLIZZARDS rolled in, very often 7,000 to 8,000 FEET HIGH, rising like MONSTROUS WAVES OF MUDDY WATER. They came day after day, year after year, through the 1930s."

THE DAMAGE

- "As the skies darkened, and the dust swept in, PEOPLE WERE BLINDED AND CHOKED."
- "CATTLE WERE SUFFOCATED TO DEATH, THEIR LUNGS CAKED WITH DUST AND MUD."
- "SAND BURIED FENCES, COVERED FIELDS, and COATED THE SURFACES OF RIVERS TILL THE FISH DIED."
- "DEAD BODIES OF BIRDS AND ANIMALS were strewn all over the landscape."
- "TRACTORS AND MACHINES that had ploughed the earth and harvested the wheat in the 1920s were now CLOGGED WITH DUST, DAMAGED BEYOND REPAIR."

Why it happened — and the two-part answer is the whole point:

Part	NCERT's words
The natural half	<i>"In part they came because the early 1930s were years of PERSISTENT DROUGHT. The rains failed year after year, and temperatures soared. The wind blew with ferocious speed"</i>
★★★★ The man-made half	<i>*"BUT ordinary duststorms became BLACK BLIZZARDS ONLY BECAUSE THE ENTIRE LANDSCAPE HAD BEEN PLOUGHED OVER, STRIPPED OF ALL GRASS THAT HELD IT TOGETHER. When wheat cultivation had expanded dramatically in the early twentieth century, ZEALOUS FARMERS HAD RECKLESSLY UPROOTED ALL VEGETATION, AND TRACTORS HAD TURNED THE SOIL OVER, AND BROKEN THE SOD INTO DUST. The whole region had become a DUST BOWL."*</i>

★★★★ "Ordinary duststorms became black blizzards ONLY BECAUSE..." — that word *only* is the examinable point. Drought is weather; the Dust Bowl was agriculture. The grass of the Great Plains was not an obstacle to farming that the tractor happily removed — it was the thing holding the soil down, and it had taken the prairie thousands of years to grow. The disk plough that made the wheat boom possible is the same instrument that made the catastrophe possible.

🔗★★★★ This is the exact same finding as Chapter 5's Maasai drought — where confinement turned the natural event of 1933–34 into the death of half a herd. Two chapters, two continents, one lesson: a natural hazard becomes a disaster only when a human system has removed the buffer that used to absorb it. For GS3 disaster management, that formulation — **hazard × vulnerability**, where vulnerability is manufactured — is the whole conceptual frame, and you have two case studies for it in one book.

NCERT's closing verdict:

★★★★ *"**The American dream of a land of plenty had turned into a nightmare.** The settlers had thought that they could **conquer the entire landscape, turn all land over to growing crops that could yield profits.** ★★ **After the 1930s, THEY REALIZED THAT THEY HAD TO RESPECT THE ECOLOGICAL CONDITIONS OF EACH REGION.**"*

3 India — The Opium Peasant

🌏 3.1 A taste for tea: the trade with China

THE TEA BOOM

1785 about 15 MILLION POUNDS of tea imported into England

1830 the figure had jumped to OVER 30 MILLION POUNDS

"In fact, THE PROFITS OF THE EAST INDIA COMPANY CAME TO
DEPEND ON THE TEA TRADE."

THE PROBLEM

"England at this time PRODUCED NOTHING THAT COULD BE
EASILY SOLD IN CHINA."

"The Confucian rulers of China, THE MANCHUS, were SUSPICIOUS
OF ALL FOREIGN MERCHANTS. They FEARED THAT THE MERCHANTS
WOULD MEDDLE IN LOCAL POLITICS AND DISRUPT THEIR AUTHORITY.
So the Manchus were UNWILLING TO ALLOW THE ENTRY OF FOREIGN
GOODS."

THE CONSEQUENCE

"They could buy tea ONLY BY PAYING IN SILVER COINS OR
BULLION. This meant AN OUTFLOW OF TREASURE FROM ENGLAND,
a prospect that created WIDESPREAD ANXIETY. It was believed
that A LOSS OF TREASURE WOULD IMPOVERISH THE NATION and
deplete its wealth."

THE SEARCH: "Merchants therefore looked for ways to
STOP THIS LOSS OF SILVER. They searched for A COMMODITY THEY
COULD SELL IN CHINA, something they could PERSUADE THE
CHINESE TO BUY."

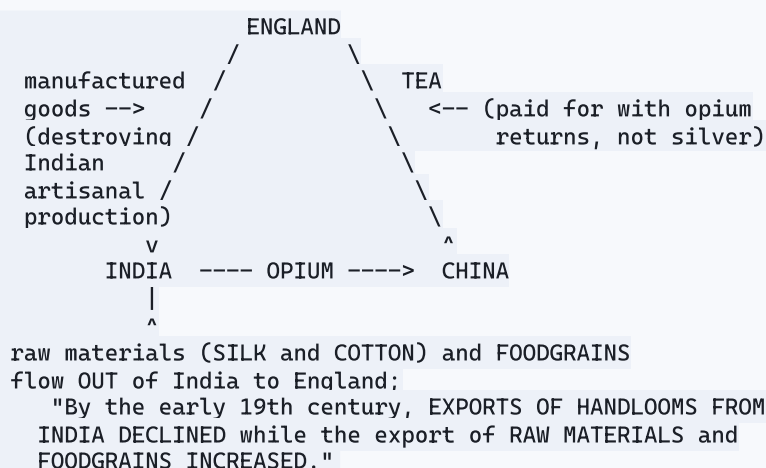
↓
O P I U M

★★★★★ **State the causation exactly, because this is what a good answer does and a weak one misses.** Britain did not push opium on China out of malice, or even primarily out of greed for opium profits. **It pushed opium because it had a trade deficit it could not otherwise close.** England wanted tea; China wanted nothing England made; the only settlement was silver; and silver leaving the country was believed to impoverish it. **Opium was the answer to a balance-of-payments problem.** Everything that follows — the addiction of millions, two wars, and the coercion of Bengali peasants — descends from an accounting difficulty.

🍷 How the opium trade grew

Fact	Detail
Origin	"The PORTUGUESE had introduced opium into China in the early sixteenth century "
★★ Its accepted use	"Opium was however known primarily for its MEDICAL PROPERTIES and used in minuscule quantities for certain types of medicines"
★★ China's own law	"The Chinese were aware of the dangers of opium addiction , and the Emperor had FORBIDDEN its production and sale except for medicinal purposes "
★★★★ The illegal trade	" Western merchants in the mid-eighteenth century began an ILLEGAL trade in opium. It was unloaded in a number of sea ports of south-eastern China and carried by local agents to the interiors "
★★ The volume	By the early 1820s, about 10,000 crates smuggled annually. Fifteen years later, over 35,000 crates every year
★★ The addicts	Lin Ze-xu , Special Commissioner at Canton in 1839 , estimated over 4 MILLION opium smokers ; " A British doctor in Canton put the figure at 12 MILLION "
★★★★ The exchange	"While the English cultivated a taste for Chinese tea, the Chinese became addicted to opium. People of all classes took to the drug — shopkeepers and peddlers, officials and army men, aristocrats and paupers... As China became a country of opium addicts, British trade in tea flourished. THE RETURNS FROM OPIUM SALE FINANCED THE TEA PURCHASES IN CHINA." *

▲ The triangular trade — ★★★★★ draw this, it explains three chapters at once



🔗 ★★★★★ This one diagram ties together material from three different books. The **de-industrialisation of Indian handlooms** (Class 8 Ch.2 and Part B of this file), the **forced commercial cropping** of indigo and opium (Class 8 Ch.3), and the **British tea habit** are **not three separate facts — they are three arms of one circuit**. If you can draw the triangle and explain each arrow, you can answer almost any question on colonial economic drain.

✂ Lin Ze-xu and the Opium War

Source E: In **1839** the Chinese Emperor sent **Lin Ze-xu** to Canton as **Special Commissioner** with instructions to stop the opium trade. After arriving in the spring of 1839, Lin **arrested 1,600 men** involved in the trade and **confiscated 11,000 pounds of opium**. He then **forced the foreign factories to hand over their stocks**, ★★ **burnt 20,000 crates of opium** and **blew the ashes to the wind**. "*When he announced that **Canton was closed to foreign trade, BRITAIN DECLARED WAR.***"

★★★ ★ "Defeated in the Opium War, the Chinese were forced to accept the humiliating terms of the subsequent treaties, **LEGALIZING OPIUM TRADE** and **OPENING UP CHINA TO FOREIGN MERCHANTS.**"* (*The First Opium War ran 1839–42.*)

Lin's "Letter of Advice to Queen Victoria", written before the war — ★★ ★★ one of the great documents of nineteenth-century world history:

*"All those people in China who sell opium or smoke opium should receive the death penalty... We find your country is **sixty or seventy thousand li** from China. Yet there are barbarian ships that strive to come here for trade **for the purpose of making a great profit. The wealth of China is used to profit the barbarians.** ... By what right do they then in return [send] us the poisonous drug to injure the Chinese people?... **LET US ASK, WHERE IS YOUR CONSCIENCE?** I have heard that the smoking of opium is **VERY STRICTLY FORBIDDEN BY YOUR COUNTRY**; that is because **THE HARM CAUSED BY OPIUM IS CLEARLY UNDERSTOOD. SINCE IT IS NOT PERMITTED TO DO HARM TO YOUR OWN COUNTRY, THEN EVEN LESS SHOULD YOU LET IT BE PASSED ON TO THE HARM OF OTHER COUNTRIES — HOW MUCH LESS TO CHINA!**"*

🎯 ★★ ★★ ★ Notice the structure of Lin's argument — it is not an appeal to mercy but a charge of **INCONSISTENCY**. He does not say *opium is bad, please stop*. He says: **you have banned it at home, therefore you already agree it is poison, therefore you are knowingly selling to others what you forbid to your own.** That is the strongest form of moral argument available — using the opponent's own conceded principle against them — and it is **exactly the move Olympe de Gouges made in Ch.1 and Samin made in Ch.4**. Three chapters, three subordinate parties, one rhetorical strategy. **Keep this quotation for any essay on double standards in international conduct.**

🌱 3.2 Where did the opium come from?

*"**This is where the Indian peasants come into the story.** When the British conquered Bengal, they made a **determined effort to produce opium in the lands under their control.**"*

Year	Chests exported from India
★★ ★ Before 1767	"no more than 500 chests " (of two maunds each)
Within four years	"the quantity TREBLED "
★★★ ★ 1870	"the government was exporting about 50,000 CHESTS annually "

Word: ★ A maund = 40 seers; 1 seer is a little under a kg — so a chest of two maunds is roughly 75 kg.

🚫 **Why the cultivators did NOT want to grow poppy —**
★★★★ **FOUR reasons, and NCERT asks for them directly**

1. IT TOOK THE BEST LAND

"The crop had to be grown on THE BEST LAND, on fields that LAY NEAR VILLAGES AND WERE WELL MANURED."

"On this land peasants usually produced PULSES. If they planted opium on this land, then PULSES COULD NOT BE GROWN THERE, or they would have to be grown on INFERIOR LAND where harvests were POORER AND UNCERTAIN."

2. MANY CULTIVATORS OWNED NO LAND

"To cultivate, they had to PAY RENT and LEASE LAND from landlords. And THE RENT CHARGED ON GOOD LANDS NEAR VILLAGES WAS VERY HIGH."

3. IT WAS A DIFFICULT AND TIME-CONSUMING CROP

"The plant was DELICATE, and cultivators had to SPEND LONG HOURS NURTURING IT. This meant that they DID NOT HAVE ENOUGH TIME TO CARE FOR OTHER CROPS."

4. THE PRICE WAS TOO LOW

"The price the government paid to the cultivators for the opium they produced WAS VERY LOW. IT WAS UNPROFITABLE FOR CULTIVATORS TO GROW OPIUM AT THAT PRICE."

★★★★ **Reason 1 deserves a sentence of its own in any answer.** The land opium needed was **the same land that grew pulses** — the household's protein and its insurance crop. So growing opium did not merely reduce income; **it displaced food security**. This is the standard mechanism by which commercial cropping impoverishes a peasantry, and you will meet it again in the indigo story (**Class 8 Ch.3**, where planters demanded exactly the best land and ryots resisted for exactly this reason).

👤 **3.3 How unwilling cultivators were made to produce opium — the system of advances**

THE CONDITION

"In the rural areas of BENGAL and BIHAR, there were large numbers of POOR PEASANTS. THEY NEVER HAD ENOUGH TO SURVIVE. It was difficult for them to PAY RENT to the landlord or to BUY FOOD AND CLOTHING."

THE OFFER -- FROM THE 1780s

"such peasants found their VILLAGE HEADMEN (mahato) giving them MONEY ADVANCES to produce opium."

"When offered a loan, the cultivators WERE TEMPTED TO ACCEPT, hoping to MEET THEIR IMMEDIATE NEEDS and PAY BACK THE LOAN AT A LATER STAGE."

THE CHAIN OF OBLIGATION

"But the loan TIED THE PEASANT TO THE HEADMAN AND THROUGH HIM TO THE GOVERNMENT."

GOVERNMENT OPIUM AGENTS -> advance money to ->
VILLAGE HEADMEN (mahato) -> who give it to ->
CULTIVATORS

WHAT THE LOAN ACTUALLY BOUGHT

"By taking the loan, the cultivator was FORCED TO:

- GROW OPIUM ON A SPECIFIED AREA OF LAND
- HAND OVER THE PRODUCE TO THE AGENTS once harvested

He had NO OPTION of planting the field with A CROP OF HIS CHOICE or of SELLING HIS PRODUCE TO ANYONE BUT THE GOVERNMENT AGENT.

And he had to ACCEPT THE LOW PRICE OFFERED."

★★★★★ **This is coercion wearing the clothes of a contract, and saying so is the answer.** No one compelled the peasant at gunpoint. He was offered **money he desperately needed**, and in accepting it he **signed away three separate freedoms at once**: what to plant, whom to sell to, and at what price. **The advance was not credit; it was the purchase of the peasant's future decisions at a discount.** 📌 **This is the identical device as the indigo *satta* in Class 8 Ch.3** — advance, contract, obligation to plant on the best land, obligation to sell to one buyer at his price. **If you understand opium you already understand indigo, and vice versa.** Use whichever the question offers and cite the other as corroboration.

💰 Where the government's opium revenue actually came from

★★★★★ **"The problem could have been partly solved by increasing the price of opium. But the government was reluctant to do so. IT WANTED TO PRODUCE OPIUM AT A CHEAP RATE AND SELL IT AT A HIGH PRICE to opium agents in Calcutta, who then shipped it to China. THIS DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THE BUYING AND SELLING PRICE WAS THE GOVERNMENT'S OPIUM REVENUE."***

🎯 **Read that once more.** The state's income was **precisely the gap between what it forced the peasant to accept and what the market would pay.** Every rupee of opium revenue was a rupee **not** paid to a Bengali cultivator. That is not a side-effect of the system; **it IS the system**, and it is why raising the price was never on the table.

🔥 Resistance, and the monopoly

Development	Detail
★★ Peasant resistance	"The prices given to the peasants were so low that angry peasants began agitating for higher prices and REFUSED TO TAKE ADVANCES "
★★ Exit	*"In regions around BENARAS , cultivators began giving up opium cultivation. They produced SUGARCANE AND POTATOES instead. "*
★★ Side-selling	"Many cultivators sold off their crop to travelling traders (PYKARS) who offered higher prices "
★★★ The monopoly	*"By 1773, the British government in Bengal had established a MONOPOLY to trade in opium. NO ONE ELSE WAS LEGALLY PERMITTED to trade in the product. "*
★★★★ The leak	"By the 1820s, the British found to their horror that opium production in their territories was rapidly DECLINING , but its production OUTSIDE British territories was INCREASING — in CENTRAL INDIA and RAJASTHAN, within princely states not under British control. There, local traders were offering MUCH HIGHER PRICES to peasants and exporting opium to China. Armed bands of traders were carrying on the trade in the 1820s"
★★ The response	"To the British this trade was ILLEGAL: it was SMUGGLING and it had to be stopped. Government monopoly had to be retained. It therefore instructed its agents posted in the princely states to CONFISCATE ALL OPIUM AND DESTROY THE CROPS "

★★★★★ **The irony here is almost too neat to be true, and it is worth stating in an answer.** The British were at that very moment **smuggling opium into China in defiance of the Chinese Emperor's ban** — and simultaneously **denouncing as "smugglers" the Indian traders who paid peasants a better price than the Company did.** *Smuggling*, in both cases, simply meant **trade the British did not control.** The word is doing political work, not legal work.

Source F — the Deputy Opium Agent of Allahabad, 1833. An **official** admission, which is what makes it valuable: *"The Board appears to think that **the cultivators are not unwilling** to cultivate. For two years past I have had constant communications with the cultivators... and **state positively the people are DISCONTENTED AND DISSATISFIED ALMOST TO A MAN**... the impression left on my mind is that ★★ **the cultivation of the poppy is CONSIDERED A CURSE BY THE PEOPLE** and that **ONLY BY UNDUE AUTHORITY IS IT UPHELD**... The cultivation was introduced **at the request, nay I may say, AT THE COMMAND of the Collector**... The people tell me, **they are ill used and abused and even BEATEN BY THE CHUPRASSIES**... The people almost uniformly told, **they suffered loss from poppy.**"*

❧ Part A — the conclusion NCERT draws

★★★★★ **"their pattern was NOT THE SAME EVERYWHERE. All sections of rural people were NOT AFFECTED IN THE SAME WAY. SOME GAINED, OTHERS LOST. Nor was the history of modernisation simply a glorious story of growth and development. It was ALSO a story of DISPLACEMENTS AND IMPOVERISHMENT, ECOLOGICAL CRISES AND SOCIAL REBELLION, COLONISATION AND REPRESSION."***

== PART B — CLOTHING: A SOCIAL HISTORY ==

The chapter's opening claim: **"It is easy to forget that there is a history to the clothes we wear. All societies observe certain rules... about the way in which men, women and children should dress... These norms come to DEFINE THE IDENTITY of people, the way they see themselves, the way they want others to see them. They shape our notions of GRACE AND BEAUTY, ideas of MODESTY AND SHAME. As times change and societies are transformed, these notions also alter. Modifications in clothing come to REFLECT these changes."***

Why the 19th and 20th centuries specifically:

Before the 18th century	After the 18th century
"most people dressed according to their regional codes , and were limited by the types of clothes and the cost of materials available in their region "	"the colonisation of most of the world by Europe , the spread of democratic ideals and the growth of an industrial society , completely changed the ways in which people thought about dress and its meanings"
★ "Clothing styles were also strictly regulated by CLASS, GENDER or STATUS in the social hierarchy "	"People could use styles and materials drawn from other cultures and locations , and ★ Western dress styles for men were adopted worldwide "

1 Sumptuary Laws and Social Hierarchy

★★★★★ **Definition to learn cold:** From about **1294** to the **French Revolution in 1789**, the people of France were expected to strictly follow ★ **"SUMPTUARY LAWS"**. *"The laws tried to **control the behaviour of those considered SOCIAL INFERIORS**, preventing them from **wearing certain clothes, consuming certain foods and beverages (usually this referred to alcohol) and HUNTING GAME in certain areas.**"*

IN MEDIEVAL FRANCE

"The items of clothing a person could purchase PER YEAR was regulated, NOT ONLY BY INCOME BUT ALSO BY SOCIAL RANK."

"THE MATERIAL to be used for clothing was also LEGALLY PRESCRIBED."

ONLY ROYALTY could wear ERMINE and FUR, or SILK, VELVET and BROCADE.

"Other classes were DEBARRED from clothing themselves with materials that were ASSOCIATED WITH THE ARISTOCRACY."

 **The phrase to notice is "not only by income but also by social rank."** A rich merchant **could afford** velvet and was **forbidden** it. That is the essence of a status society — **money could not buy you out of your rank**. When sumptuary laws fall, money *can*; that is the whole change described in section 2.

FR What the French Revolution did

"The French Revolution ended these distinctions." — and the evidence is dress itself:

Change	Detail
★★ Sans-culottes	Members of the Jacobin clubs called themselves this " <i>to distinguish themselves from the aristocracy who wore the fashionable knee breeches</i> " — <i>sans culottes</i> literally " those without knee breeches "
Comfort	"From now on, both men and women began wearing clothing that was LOOSE AND COMFORTABLE "
★ The colours	"The colours of France — blue, white and red — became popular as they were a sign of the patriotic citizen "
★ The symbols	"the RED CAP OF LIBERTY, long trousers and the revolutionary COCKADE pinned on to a hat"
★★★ The meaning	*"The SIMPLICITY of clothing was meant to EXPRESS THE IDEA OF EQUALITY ."*

Words: ★ **Cockade** — cap, usually worn on one side. ★ **Ermine** — type of fur.  **This section is a direct continuation of Chapter 1** — go back and re-read the *sans-culottes* passage and Box 1 on political symbols. **The Revolution abolished sumptuary law and then immediately invented a dress code of its own** (the red cap, the tricolour, the long trousers) — and note from Ch.1 that **women were not allowed to wear the red cap**. *Equality in dress was itself unequally distributed.*

Box 1 — the OTHER purpose of sumptuary law

★★★★ *"Not all sumptuary laws were meant to emphasise social hierarchy. Some sumptuary laws were passed to **PROTECT HOME PRODUCTION AGAINST IMPORTS**. For instance, in **sixteenth-century England**, velvet caps made with material **imported from France and Italy** were popular amongst men. **England passed a law which compelled all persons over SIX YEARS of age, except those of high position, to wear WOOLLEN CAPS MADE IN ENGLAND, on Sundays and all holy days**. This law remained in effect for **TWENTY-SIX YEARS** and was **VERY USEFUL IN BUILDING UP THE ENGLISH WOOLLEN INDUSTRY**."*

★★★★★ **Do not skip this box — it is the sharpest cross-link in the chapter.** England legally compelled its own people to wear domestic cloth in order to build a domestic textile industry. Three centuries later, England's mills having destroyed India's handlooms, **Indians voluntarily boycotted foreign cloth to rebuild their own** (§5.1 below). **Protectionism by statute in Tudor England; protectionism by mass pledge in Swadeshi Bengal**. Same economic logic, opposite relationship to state power — and the second one is a *nationalist movement* precisely because the state was not theirs to command.

2 Clothing and Notions of Beauty

⚖️ What replaced sumptuary law

*"The end of sumptuary laws **did not mean that everyone in European societies could now dress in the same way... differences between social strata remained. Clearly, the poor could not dress like the rich, nor eat the same food. BUT LAWS NO LONGER BARRED PEOPLE'S RIGHT TO DRESS IN THE WAY THEY WISHED.** ★★ ★ DIFFERENCES IN EARNING, RATHER THAN SUMPTUARY LAWS, NOW DEFINED WHAT THE RICH AND POOR COULD WEAR. And different classes developed their own culture of dress."*

🎯 ★★ ★★ **One line for your answer:** the constraint did not disappear, **it changed from LAW to MONEY** — from a barrier you could never cross to one you could, in principle, buy your way over. That is the difference between a **status** society and a **class** society, and dress is where you can see it happening.

👗 The Victorian corset — clothing as an argument about womanhood

THE IDEAL BEING TAUGHT

"Women in Victorian England were GROOMED FROM CHILDHOOD to be DOCILE AND DUTIFUL, SUBMISSIVE AND OBEDIENT.

THE IDEAL WOMAN WAS ONE WHO COULD BEAR PAIN AND SUFFERING."

MEN were expected to be	WOMEN were seen as
SERIOUS	FRIVOLOUS
STRONG	DELICATE
INDEPENDENT	PASSIVE
AGGRESSIVE	DOCILE

"NORMS OF CLOTHING REFLECTED THESE IDEALS."

- "From childhood, girls were TIGHTLY LACED UP and dressed in STAYS. THE EFFORT WAS TO RESTRICT THE GROWTH OF THEIR BODIES, CONTAIN THEM WITHIN SMALL MOULDS."
- "When slightly older, girls had to wear TIGHT FITTING CORSETS."
- "TIGHTLY LACED, SMALL-WAISTED WOMEN WERE ADMIRE AS ATTRACTIVE, ELEGANT AND GRACEFUL."

"CLOTHING THUS PLAYED A PART IN CREATING THE IMAGE OF FRAIL, SUBMISSIVE VICTORIAN WOMEN."

Words: ★ **Stays** — support as part of a woman's dress to hold the body straight. ★ **Corset** — a closely fitting and stiff inner bodice, worn by women to give shape and support to the figure. **Busk** — a strip of wood, whalebone or steel in front of the corset to stiffen and support it. **Suffrage** — the right to vote.

★★★★★ **The crucial move to notice, and it will earn you marks:** the corset did not merely *express* the belief that women were frail — **it MANUFACTURED the frailty it claimed to describe.** Restricted growth, hampered circulation, underdeveloped muscles, bent spines, women "*complaining of acute weakness, felt languid, and fainted frequently*" — and then, in NCERT's devastating final turn, ★ **"corsets then became NECESSARY to hold up the weakened spine."** The remedy created the condition it was then required to treat. 🔗 This is the same logic as the Nazi stereotype in Ch.3, manufactured for an assimilated community and then enforced by the yellow star; and the same as colonial "**waste land**" in Ch.5, a category invented and then used as proof. **A description that produces the thing it describes is one of the most transferable ideas in this whole book.**

🤔 2.1 How did women react? — ★★☆☆ note that they *divided*

Many accepted it:

"Many women believed in the ideals of womanhood. ★ The ideals were IN THE AIR THEY BREATHED, THE LITERATURE THEY READ, THE EDUCATION THEY HAD RECEIVED AT SCHOOL AND AT HOME. From childhood they grew up to believe that having a small waist was a WOMANLY DUTY. Suffering pain was ESSENTIAL TO BEING A WOMAN. To be seen as attractive, to be womanly, they had to wear the corset. THE TORTURE AND PAIN THIS INFLICTED ON THE BODY WAS TO BE ACCEPTED AS NORMAL."*

Source A — Mary Somerville, one of the first woman mathematicians, on her childhood:

"Although perfectly straight and well made, I was encased in stiff stays, with a steel busk in front, while above my frock, bands drew my shoulder back until the shoulder blades met. Then a steel rod with a semi-circle, which went under my chin, was clasped to the steel busk in my stays. IN THIS CONSTRAINED STATE, I AND MOST OF THE YOUNGER GIRLS HAD TO PREPARE OUR LESSONS." 🎯 *"Although perfectly straight and well made" — she was corrected for a deformity she did not have.* And note where it happens: **while doing her lessons.** One of the first women mathematicians in the world learned her mathematics in a steel frame.

Source B — the Registrar General, Ninth Annual Report of 1857, i.e. an official government objection: **"It is evident physiologically that air is the pabulum of life, and that the effect of a tight cord round the neck and of tight lacing differ only in DEGREES... for the strangulations are BOTH FATAL. To wear tight stays in many cases is to WITHER, TO WASTE, TO DIE."** (*Pabulum — anything essential to maintain life and growth.*)

Source C — the literary ideal being sold. John Keats described his ideal woman as ★ "a milk-white lamb that bleats for man's protection." Thackeray, in *Vanity Fair* (1848), on Amelia: "I think it was her WEAKNESS which was her principal charm, a kind of sweet submission and softness, which seemed to appeal to each man she met, for his sympathy and protection."

And many did not accept it:

"But not everyone accepted these values. Over the nineteenth century, ideas changed. ★★ By the 1830s, women in England began agitating for democratic rights. As the SUFFRAGE MOVEMENT developed, many began campaigning for DRESS REFORM."*

us Rational dress reform on both sides of the Atlantic

The American case, and note the *economic* argument:

"Long skirts, it was said, swept the grounds and collected filth and dirt. This caused illness. The skirts were voluminous and difficult to handle. They hampered movement and PREVENTED WOMEN FROM WORKING AND EARNING. ★★ REFORM OF THE DRESS, IT WAS SAID, WOULD CHANGE THE POSITION OF WOMEN. If clothes were COMFORTABLE AND CONVENIENT, then women could WORK, EARN THEIR LIVING, AND BECOME INDEPENDENT."*

Organisation	Leader	Date
★★ National Woman Suffrage Association	Mrs Stanton	campaigning for dress reform in the 1870s
★★ American Woman Suffrage Association	Lucy Stone	same
★★ The Rational Dress Society	in England	started 1881 — "but did not achieve significant results"

★★ The argument, in three words: *"simplify dress, shorten skirts, and abandon corsets."*

★★★★ Box 2 — Mrs AMELIA BLOOMER, an American, *"was the first dress reformer to launch LOOSE TUNICS worn over ANKLE-LENGTH TROUSERS. The trousers were known as ★ 'BLOOMERS', 'RATIONALS', or 'KNICKERBOCKERS'."* ★★★★★ And the box's punchline: *"It was the FIRST WORLD WAR that brought about radical changes in women's clothing."*

The backlash:

"The reformers did not immediately succeed in changing social values. They had to face RIDICULE AND HOSTILITY. Conservatives everywhere opposed change. They lamented that women who gave up traditional norms of dressing NO LONGER LOOKED BEAUTIFUL, and LOST THEIR FEMININITY AND GRACE. Faced with persistent attacks, MANY WOMEN REFORMERS CHANGED BACK INTO TRADITIONAL CLOTHES to conform to conventions."

🌀★★★★★ Hold Box 2 and this paragraph together, because between them they make the chapter's best argument. Fifty years of organised campaigning by two national associations and a dedicated society **failed**. Then the war came, **700,000 women went into ammunition factories**, and the hemline rose in a year. **Argument did not change the dress code; changed work did.** That is a genuinely important point about how social norms actually move — and it is a first-rate essay thesis.

3 New Times

📦 3.1 New materials

Period	Change
Before the 17th century	<i>"most ordinary women in Britain possessed very few clothes made of flax, linen or wool, which were difficult to clean"</i>
★★★★ After 1600	<i>"trade with INDIA brought CHEAP, BEAUTIFUL and EASY-TO-MAINTAIN INDIAN CHINTZES within the reach of many Europeans who could now increase the size of their wardrobes"</i>
★★ 19th century	<i>"during the Industrial Revolution, Britain began the MASS MANUFACTURE OF COTTON TEXTILES which it exported to many parts of the world, INCLUDING INDIA. Cotton clothes became more accessible to a wider section of people in Europe"</i>
Early 20th century	<i>"artificial fibres made clothes cheaper still and easier to wash and maintain"</i>
★ Late 1870s	<i>"heavy, restrictive underclothes... were gradually discarded. Clothes got lighter, shorter and simpler"</i>

Word: ★ Chintz — cotton cloth printed with designs and flowers. From the Hindi word *chint*.

★★★★★ Read the second and third rows together — that is the entire colonial economic story in two lines of a clothing chapter. India clothed Europe in the 1600s; Britain clothed India in the 1800s. The direction of the cloth trade reversed completely, and §5.1 below is about what Indians did in response.

★ ★ And the fact that dates the change: *"Yet until 1914, clothes were ANKLE LENGTH, as they had been SINCE THE THIRTEENTH CENTURY. BY 1915, however, the hemline of the skirt rose dramatically to MID-CALF."* — Seven hundred years, then one year.

🔴 3.2 The war

Change	Detail
Class mixing	<i>"Many European women stopped wearing jewellery and luxurious clothes. As upper-class women mixed with other classes, SOCIAL BARRIERS WERE ERODED and women began to dress in similar ways"</i>
★ ★ ★ The factories	<i>"By 1917, over 700,000 WOMEN IN BRITAIN were employed in AMMUNITION FACTORIES."* They wore "a working uniform of blouse and trousers with accessories such as scarves, which was later replaced by KHAKI OVERALLS AND CAPS"</i>
Colour	<i>"Bright colours faded from sight and only SOBER COLOURS were worn as the war dragged on. Thus clothes became plainer and simpler"</i>
★ ★ Trousers	<i>"Skirts became shorter. Soon TROUSERS became a VITAL PART of Western women's clothing, giving them GREATER FREEDOM OF MOVEMENT."*</i>
★ ★ Hair	<i>"Most important, women took to CUTTING THEIR HAIR SHORT for convenience."*</i>
After	<i>"By the twentieth century, a plain and austere style came to reflect SERIOUSNESS AND PROFESSIONALISM. New schools for children emphasised the importance of plain dressing, and discouraged ornamentation. ★ GYMNASTICS AND GAMES entered the school curriculum for women. As women took to sports, they had to wear clothes that did not hamper movement"</i>

★ ★ ★ The summary sentence NCERT gives, and it is the thesis of the whole chapter: *"the history of clothing is linked to the LARGER HISTORY OF SOCIETY... clothing was **defined by dominant cultural attitudes and ideals of beauty**... reformers and conservatives struggled to shape these ideals... and changes within TECHNOLOGY AND ECONOMY, and the PRESSURES OF NEW TIMES, made people feel the need for change."*

4 Transformations in Colonial India

The two forces: *"On the one hand this was a consequence of the **influence of Western dress forms and MISSIONARY ACTIVITY**; on the other it was due to **the effort by Indians to fashion clothing styles that embodied AN INDIGENOUS TRADITION AND CULTURE**. ★ ★ Cloth and clothing in fact became **VERY IMPORTANT SYMBOLS OF THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT**."**

🔥 The THREE reactions — ★★★★★ NCERT numbers them, so learn them numbered

ONE – ADOPT

"Many, ESPECIALLY MEN, began INCORPORATING SOME ELEMENTS of western-style clothing."

"The wealthy PARSIS of western India were AMONG THE FIRST to adapt Western-style clothing." Baggy trousers and the PHENTA (or hat) added to long COLLARLESS COATS, with BOOTS and a WALKING STICK "to complete the look of the gentleman."

"To some, Western clothes were A SIGN OF MODERNITY AND PROGRESS."

"Western-style clothing was ALSO ESPECIALLY ATTRACTIVE to groups of DALIT CONVERTS TO CHRISTIANITY WHO NOW FOUND IT LIBERATING. Here too, it was MEN rather than WOMEN who affected the new dress styles."

TWO – REJECT

"There were others who were convinced that WESTERN CULTURE WOULD LEAD TO A LOSS OF TRADITIONAL CULTURAL IDENTITY. The use of Western-style clothes was taken as A SIGN OF THE WORLD TURNING UPSIDE DOWN."

The cartoon of the BENGALI BABU mocked him for wearing "Western-style boots and hat and coat ALONG WITH HIS DHOTI." Gaganendranath Tagore's cartoon 'THE MODERN PATRIOT' -- "a sarcastic picture of a foolish man who COPIES WESTERN DRESS BUT CLAIMS TO LOVE HIS MOTHERLAND WITH ALL HIS HEART."

THREE – COMPARTMENTALISE

"Some men resolved this dilemma by WEARING WESTERN CLOTHES WITHOUT GIVING UP THEIR INDIAN ONES."

"Many BENGALI BUREAUCRATS in the late nineteenth century began stocking western-style clothes FOR WORK OUTSIDE THE HOME and CHANGED INTO MORE COMFORTABLE INDIAN CLOTHES AT HOME."

VERRIER ELWIN remembered that POLICEMEN IN POONA going off duty "would TAKE THEIR TROUSERS OFF IN THE STREET and walk home in 'just tunic and undergarments'."

"THIS DIFFERENCE BETWEEN OUTER AND INNER WORLDS IS STILL OBSERVED BY SOME MEN TODAY."

★★★★★ **Reaction One contains something important that is easy to skim past.** For Dalit converts, Western dress was **liberating** — because Indian dress codes were **caste codes**, and a suit belonged to no caste. **The same garment that signified surrender to one Indian was an escape from humiliation to another.** This is why you cannot evaluate "Westernisation" as a single thing, and it is the direct ancestor of **Ambedkar's three-piece suit** in §5.3. ★★ **And note the recurring gender asymmetry across all three reactions: "it was MEN rather than WOMEN."** Men changed; women were expected to carry the tradition. Hold that for §5's question on why women kept traditional dress.

✂ 4.1 Caste conflict and dress change — the Shanar (Nadar) revolt

★★★★★ **The framing sentence — quote it: "Though there were NO FORMAL SUMPTUARY LAWS as in Europe, India had its own strict social codes of food and dress. THE CASTE SYSTEM CLEARLY DEFINED WHAT SUBORDINATE AND DOMINANT CASTE HINDUS SHOULD WEAR, EAT, ETC., AND THESE CODES HAD THE FORCE OF LAW. Changes in clothing styles that threatened these norms therefore often created VIOLENT SOCIAL REACTIONS."**

Who the Shanars were:

- ★ "The **SHANARS (also called NADARS)** were a community of **TODDY TAPPERS** who **migrated to southern TRAVANCORE to work under NAIR landlords.**"

- * "As they were considered a '**subordinate caste**', they were **prohibited from using UMBRELLAS and wearing SHOES or GOLDEN ORNAMENTS.**"*
- ★★ * "**Men and women were also expected to follow the local custom of NEVER COVERING THEIR UPPER BODIES BEFORE THE UPPER CASTES.**"*

The sequence — ★★ ★★ learn all five dates:

1820s "Under the influence of CHRISTIAN MISSIONS, Shanar women converts began to wear TAILORED BLOUSES AND CLOTHS TO COVER THEMSELVES LIKE THE UPPER CASTES."

MAY 1822 "Women of the Shanar caste were ATTACKED BY UPPER-CASTE NAIRS IN PUBLIC PLACES in the southern princely state of TRAVANCORE, FOR WEARING A CLOTH ACROSS THEIR UPPER BODIES."

Nairs "TORE OFF THEIR UPPER CLOTHS."

"Complaints were also filed in court against this dress change, ESPECIALLY SINCE SHANARS WERE ALSO REFUSING TO RENDER FREE LABOUR FOR THE UPPER CASTES."

1829 THE FIRST PROCLAMATION

"The Government of Travancore issued a proclamation ordering Shanar women 'TO ABSTAIN IN FUTURE FROM COVERING THE UPPER PARTS OF THE BODY.'"

"BUT THIS DID NOT PREVENT Shanar Christian women, AND EVEN SHANAR HINDUS, from adopting the blouse and upper cloth."

1855 "THE ABOLITION OF SLAVERY IN TRAVANCORE led to EVEN MORE FRUSTRATION AMONG THE UPPER CASTES WHO FELT THEY WERE LOSING CONTROL."

OCTOBER 1859 "RIOTS BROKE OUT as Shanar women were ATTACKED IN THE MARKETPLACE AND STRIPPED OF THEIR UPPER CLOTHS. HOUSES WERE LOOTED AND CHAPELS BURNED."

THE SECOND PROCLAMATION

"Finally, the government issued another proclamation PERMITTING SHANAR WOMEN, WHETHER CHRISTIAN OR HINDU, TO WEAR A JACKET, OR COVER THEIR UPPER BODIES 'IN ANY MANNER WHATEVER, BUT NOT LIKE THE WOMEN OF HIGH CASTE.'"

★★★★ That final clause is one of the most revealing sentences in the whole NCERT History series, and you should be able to unpack it in an answer. The state concedes **the covering** but forbids **the manner**. Why? Because **the grievance was never modesty — it was EQUIVALENCE**. What the Nairs could not tolerate was not that Shanar women were covered, but that they were covered *in the same way as upper-caste women*, which would make the two visually indistinguishable. **Caste is maintained by legible difference; the blouse threatened the legibility, not the morality**. The compromise permits the body to be covered while ensuring the caste can still be read off the clothing.

🎯 Two further points worth making. First, note **why the court complaints came**: "*especially since Shanars were also **refusing to render free labour**.*" **The dress revolt and the labour revolt were the same revolt** — clothing was the visible edge of a withdrawal of subordination. Second, note the **1855 detail**: the abolition of slavery **intensified** the reaction. **Upper-caste anxiety rose as its other instruments of control fell away**, and dress became the last line held. 🔗 **Cross-link to Class 8 Ch.7 (Women, Caste and Reform)** — this belongs beside Jyotirao Phule, Ambedkar and Periyar as an early, **self-organised, woman-led** assertion of caste dignity, and it predates all of them.

4.2 British rule and dress codes

"In different cultures, **specific items of clothing often convey CONTRARY MEANINGS**. This frequently leads to **misunderstanding and conflict**."

Conflict 1 — the turban and the hat:

	THE TURBAN (India)	THE HAT (the West)
What it meant	★ "not just for protection from the heat but A SIGN OF RESPECTABILITY , and COULD NOT BE REMOVED AT WILL "	★ "the hat HAD TO BE REMOVED before social superiors AS A SIGN OF RESPECT "
The result	★★★ "The British were often OFFENDED if Indians did not take off their turban when they met colonial officials." *	★★★ "Many Indians on the other hand wore the turban to CONSCIOUSLY ASSERT THEIR REGIONAL OR NATIONAL IDENTITY." *

★★★ The point: the same physical act — keeping the head covered — meant **dignity** in one code and **insolence** in the other. European traders were in fact distinguished from Indian "**turban wearers**" as the "**hat wearers**". This is the cleanest available example of how **colonial conflict was often a collision of grammars, not of intentions** — though of course only one side had the power to make its grammar compulsory.

★★ Box 3 — the Mysore turban (*peta*), "**edged with GOLD LACE**, and adopted as part of the **DURBAR DRESS of the Mysore court in the mid-nineteenth century**. By the end of the nineteenth century, a wide variety of **officials, teachers and artists** in Mysore began wearing the turban, **SOMETIMES WITH THE WESTERN SUIT**, as **a sign of belonging to the princely state**. Today, the Mysore turban is used largely on **ceremonial occasions and to honour visiting dignitaries**." —

★ Sir M. Visvesvaraya, the engineer-technocrat and **Dewan of Mysore 1912–1918**, "**wore a turban with his three-piece Western style suit**."

Conflict 2 — "shoe respect":

EARLY 19th c. "It was CUSTOMARY FOR BRITISH OFFICIALS TO FOLLOW INDIAN ETIQUETTE and REMOVE THEIR FOOTWEAR in the courts of ruling kings or chiefs. SOME BRITISH OFFICIALS ALSO WORE INDIAN CLOTHES."

1830 "EUROPEANS WERE FORBIDDEN FROM WEARING INDIAN CLOTHES AT OFFICIAL FUNCTIONS, SO THAT THE CULTURAL IDENTITY OF THE WHITE MASTERS WAS NOT UNDERMINED."

"At the same time, INDIANS WERE EXPECTED TO WEAR INDIAN CLOTHES TO OFFICE and follow Indian dress codes."

1824-1828 Governor-General AMHERST "insisted that Indians TAKE THEIR SHOES OFF as a sign of respect when they appeared before him, BUT THIS WAS NOT STRICTLY FOLLOWED."

MID-19th c. Under Governor-General LORD DALHOUSIE, "'SHOE RESPECT' WAS MADE STRICTER, and Indians were made to TAKE OFF THEIR SHOES WHEN ENTERING ANY GOVERNMENT INSTITUTION;

ONLY THOSE WHO WORE EUROPEAN CLOTHES WERE EXEMPTED FROM THIS RULE."

★★★★ Look hard at the 1830 rule and the exemption together, because between them they give away the whole logic. Europeans were **forbidden** Indian dress "so that the cultural identity of the white masters was not undermined" — and Indians in **European** dress were **exempted** from shoe-respect. **So dress was not about culture at all; it was a marker of rank.** The rule was: *look like a ruler and you are treated as one; look Indian and you will take your shoes off.* **Colonial cultural policy was a machine for making hierarchy visible**, which is precisely why nationalists later fought it with clothing.

The Surat case, 1862 — ★★★★★ a named individual worth remembering:

"Manockjee Cowasjee Entee, an assessor in the Surat Fouzdaree Adawlut, REFUSED to take off his shoes in the court of the sessions judge. The judge insisted that he take off his shoes as that was the Indian way of showing respect to superiors. But Manockjee remained adamant. He was BARRED ENTRY into the courtroom and he sent a letter of protest to the GOVERNOR OF BOMBAY."

The two-part Indian argument in the controversy that followed:

*"the British insisted that **since Indians took off their shoes when they entered a sacred place or home, they should do so when they entered the courtroom.** In the controversy that followed, **Indians urged that taking off shoes in sacred places and at home was linked to TWO DIFFERENT QUESTIONS.** ★ **One: there was the problem of DIRT AND FILTH.** Shoes collected the dirt on the road. This dirt could not be allowed into spaces that were clean, **particularly when people in Indian homes SAT ON THE GROUND.** ★ **Second: leather shoes and the filth that stuck under it were seen as POLLUTING.** ★★ **BUT PUBLIC BUILDINGS LIKE THE COURTROOM WERE DIFFERENT FROM HOME. ... But it took MANY YEARS before shoes were permitted into the courtroom.**"*

Source D — Manockjee to the judge: *"Taking off my pugree would have been a greater insult to myself than to the court, BUT I WOULD HAVE SUBMITTED TO IT, because there is nothing of conscience, or religion involved in it. I hold no respect or disrespect... in the shoes, but the putting ON of our turban is the greatest of all respects that we pay. We do not have our pugrees on when at home, but when we go out to see respectable persons we are bound by social etiquette to have it ON..."* 🎯 ★★★★★ Manockjee's argument is beautifully precise and repays close reading. He offers to remove **the turban** — the thing the British *thought* was the sacred item — and refuses on **the shoes**. His reasoning: **removing the turban is merely humiliating, and he could bear that; the shoe rule requires him to enact a form of deference reserved for the sacred and the domestic, in a PUBLIC building.** He is not defending a custom; he is **refusing a category error** deliberately imposed to place him below the court. **The distinction between what is merely insulting and what is a false claim about your status is exactly what makes this a case worth teaching.**

5 Designing the National Dress

"As nationalist feelings swept across India by the late nineteenth century, Indians began devising CULTURAL SYMBOLS that would express the UNITY OF THE NATION. Artists looked for a national style of art. Poets wrote national songs. Then a debate began over the design of the NATIONAL FLAG. THE SEARCH FOR A NATIONAL DRESS WAS PART OF THIS MOVE to define the cultural identity of the nation in symbolic ways."

Experiment	Detail
★★ The Tagore family, from the 1870s	"experimented... with designs for a national dress for BOTH MEN AND WOMEN in India"
★★★ Rabindranath Tagore's proposal	"instead of combining Indian and European dress , India's national dress should COMBINE ELEMENTS OF HINDU AND MUSLIM DRESS . Thus the ★ CHAPKAN (a long buttoned coat) was considered the most suitable dress for men"
★★★ The Brahmika sari	In the late 1870s, ★ Jnanadanandini Devi, wife of Satyendranath Tagore, the first Indian member of the ICS, returned from Bombay to Calcutta. She adopted the ★ PARSI style of wearing the sari — pinned to the LEFT SHOULDER with a BROOCH , and worn with a BLOUSE AND SHOES . "This was quickly adopted by Brahmo Samaji women and came to be known as the BRAHMIKA SARI ", gaining acceptance among Maharashtrian and Uttar Pradesh Brahmos, as well as non-Brahmos
★★ The verdict	*"However, these attempts at devising a PAN-INDIAN style DID NOT FULLY SUCCEED. Women of Gujarat, Kodagu, Kerala and Assam continue to wear different types of sari."*

★★★★ Rabindranath's proposal is worth pausing on, because it tells you what "national" meant to him. He rejected the obvious synthesis (**Indian + European**) in favour of a harder one (**Hindu + Muslim**) — treating the real problem of Indian nationhood as **internal unity**, not **external distinctiveness**. That is a substantial political position expressed as a coat. ★★ And note who actually succeeded: not the theorists but **Jnanadanandini Devi**, who simply borrowed a **Parsi** way of draping and let it spread. **The national dress that took hold was regional in origin, practical in motive, and adopted from below** — and even it did not become universal. **The failure is the finding:** a country whose women in four named regions still drape differently was telling the nationalists something about what "unity" could and could not mean.

Sources E and F — two notions of shame, from Bengal and Kerala, in the same period: (Bengal, criticising existing dress) — "**Any civilised nation is against the kind of clothing in use in the present time among women of our country. Indeed it is a SIGN OF SHAMELESSNESS... There is a custom here of women wearing fine and transparent clothing which reveals the whole body. Such shameless attire in no way allows one to frequent civilised company...**" (Kerala, on first wearing a blouse) — *"**It looked good, but I felt ticklish wearing it... I showed it to my [mother]. She gave me a stern look and said 'Where are you going to gallivant in this? Fold it and keep it in the box.'**... At night I wore it once more and showed it to my husband. **He said it looked good...** [the next morning] I came out wearing the blouse... Suddenly I heard her break a piece from a coconut branch... she said ★ **'TAKE IT OFF... you want to walk around in SHIRTS LIKE MUSLIM WOMEN?'**"* 🌀

★★★★ Put these two side by side and you have an entire Indian Society answer. In Bengal, the reformer's complaint is that women wear **too little** and it is shameless. In Kerala, the mother's complaint is that a woman wears **too much** and it is shameless. **"Shame" is not a property of the garment; it is a property of the local order the garment threatens.** And note that in Kerala the objection is expressed as **communal boundary policing** — *shirts like Muslim women* — while the Shanar case shows the same instinct expressed as **caste boundary policing**. **The specific taboo varies; the function does not.**

IN 5.1 The Swadeshi Movement

The economic background — ★★★ these figures are directly usable:

Fact	Detail
★★ 17th century	"India accounted for ONE-FOURTH of the world's manufactured goods"
★★ Mid-18th century	"There were A MILLION WEAVERS IN BENGAL ALONE "
★★★ The reversal	"the Industrial Revolution in Britain , which mechanised spinning and weaving and greatly increased the demand for raw materials such as COTTON AND INDIGO , CHANGED INDIA'S STATUS IN THE WORLD ECONOMY "
★★★★ How political control mattered	*"Political control of India helped the British in TWO WAYS : Indian peasants could be FORCED TO GROW CROPS such as indigo, and cheap British manufacture EASILY REPLACED COARSER INDIAN ONE ."*
★★ The casualties	"Large numbers of Indian weavers and spinners were left WITHOUT WORK , and important textile weaving centres such as ★ MURSHIDABAD, MACHILIPATNAM and SURAT DECLINED as demand fell"

🔗 ★★★★★ "Political control helped the British in two ways" is the single most compressed statement of colonial economics in the NCERT corpus. Note that it names **both** ends of the circuit: **coercion of supply** (forced cropping) and **capture of demand** (cheap manufactures displacing Indian cloth). **Neither alone would have done it**. Free trade between equals would not have produced this; **the political control is doing the work in both halves**. Set it beside the opium triangle in Part A and you have the full argument.

The movement itself:

1905 "LORD CURZON decided to partition Bengal TO CONTROL THE GROWING OPPOSITION to British rule. THE SWADESHI MOVEMENT DEVELOPED IN REACTION."

THE PROGRAMME

- "People were urged to **BOYCOTT BRITISH GOODS OF ALL KINDS**"
- "and **START THEIR OWN INDUSTRIES** for the manufacture of goods such as **MATCHBOXES AND CIGARETTES**"
- "Mass protests followed, with people **VOWING TO CLEANSE THEMSELVES OF COLONIAL RULE**"
- "THE USE OF **KHADI WAS MADE A PATRIOTIC DUTY**"
- "WOMEN were urged to **THROW AWAY THEIR SILKS AND GLASS BANGLES** and wear **SIMPLE SHELL BANGLES**"
- "ROUGH HOMESPUN was **GLORIFIED IN SONGS AND POEMS** to popularise it"

THE LIMITS -- state these, they are the examinable part

- "The change of dress appealed **LARGELY TO THE UPPER CASTES AND CLASSES** rather than to **THOSE WHO HAD TO MAKE DO WITH LESS AND COULD NOT AFFORD THE NEW PRODUCTS**."

- "AFTER 15 YEARS, MANY AMONG THE UPPER CLASSES ALSO RETURNED TO WEARING EUROPEAN DRESS."
- "It was **ALMOST IMPOSSIBLE TO COMPETE WITH CHEAP BRITISH GOODS** that had flooded the market."

THE LEGACY

"DESPITE ITS LIMITATIONS, the experiment with Swadeshi gave MAHATMA GANDHI IMPORTANT IDEAS ABOUT USING CLOTH AS A SYMBOLIC WEAPON AGAINST BRITISH RULE."

★★★★★ The poverty objection is the heart of it, and NCERT asks you about it directly. Khadi was **coarser, MORE EXPENSIVE and difficult to obtain** than mill cloth. So "**boycott the cheap thing and buy the dear thing**" is a demand only the comfortable can meet. Swadeshi asked the poor to **subsidise a symbol**. That is why it stalled — and it is the problem Gandhi spent the next twenty years trying to solve by **making people spin the cloth themselves** rather than buy it.

📖 5.2 Gandhi's experiments with clothing —

★★★★★ learn the sequence, each step is an argument

BOY, GUJARATI BANIA FAMILY
"usually wore a SHIRT WITH A DHOTI OR PYJAMA, and sometimes A COAT"
|
1888, AGE 19, LONDON (to study law)
"He CUT OFF THE TUFT ON HIS HEAD and dressed in a WESTERN SUIT SO THAT HE WOULD NOT BE LAUGHED AT."
|
ON HIS RETURN
"he continued to wear WESTERN SUITS, TOPPED WITH A TURBAN"
|
1890s, JOHANNESBURG (as a lawyer)
"he STILL WORE WESTERN CLOTHES"
|
THE TURN
"Soon he decided that DRESSING 'UNSUITABLY' WAS A MORE POWERFUL POLITICAL STATEMENT."
|
1913, DURBAN
"Gandhi FIRST APPEARED IN A LUNGI AND KURTA WITH HIS HEAD SHAVED AS A SIGN OF MOURNING, TO PROTEST AGAINST THE SHOOTING OF INDIAN COAL MINERS."
|
1915, RETURN TO INDIA
"he decided to DRESS LIKE A KATHIAWADI PEASANT"
|
1921 -- THE SHORT DHOTI, "the form of dress he wore UNTIL HIS DEATH"

The announcement — ★★★★★ 22 September 1921, a year after launching Non-Cooperation:

"I propose to discard at least up to 31st of October my topi and vest and to content myself with a LOINCLOTH, and a CHADDAR whenever necessary for protection of my body. I ADOPT THE CHANGE BECAUSE I HAVE ALWAYS HESITATED TO ADVISE ANYTHING I MAY NOT BE PREPARED TO FOLLOW..."

★★★★★ That last clause is a complete ethic of leadership in fourteen words, and it is **Ethics-paper gold**. *I have always hesitated to advise anything I may not be prepared to follow*. Note also what the announcement was: **an experiment with an end date** — *"at this time he did not want to use this dress all his life and only wanted to 'experiment for a month or two'."* **He was not making a vow; he was testing a claim.** *"But soon he saw this as his DUTY TO THE POOR, and HE NEVER WORE ANY OTHER DRESS."*

What the choice meant:

★★★★★ *"He CONSCIOUSLY REJECTED THE WELL-KNOWN CLOTHES OF THE INDIAN ASCETIC and adopted THE DRESS OF THE POOREST INDIAN. Khadi, WHITE AND COARSE, was to him a sign of PURITY, of SIMPLICITY, and of POVERTY. Wearing it became also a symbol of NATIONALISM, a REJECTION OF WESTERN MILL-MADE CLOTH."*

🎯 ★★★★★ The rejection of the ascetic's robe is the most important detail here and almost everyone misses it. India had a ready-made, respected costume for a man renouncing worldly goods — **the saffron of the sannyasi**. Gandhi refused it. **The ascetic's robe says *I have risen above ordinary people*; the poor man's loincloth says *I have come down to them*.** One is a claim to holiness, the other to solidarity. **He chose the dress of the poorest Indian, not the dress of the holiest.**

And the Round Table Conference, 1931:

*"He wore the **short dhoti WITHOUT A SHIRT** when he went to England for the **ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE in 1931**. He **REFUSED TO COMPROMISE** and wore it **EVEN BEFORE KING GEORGE V at Buckingham Palace**. When asked by journalists whether he was **wearing enough clothes to go before the King**, he joked that ★★ **'the King had enough on for both of us!'**"*

★★★ Churchill's reaction is the standard exam prompt: he described Gandhi as "*a seditious Middle Temple lawyer now posing as a half naked fakir*." Read the insult carefully — it **concedes the point**. Churchill is enraged precisely because he recognises **both** identities as real: the man is a Middle Temple lawyer, and the loincloth is deliberate. **The word "posing" is an admission that the dress was an argument, and that it was landing**. If a rival's costume is worth attacking in the House of Commons, it is working.

📦 Box 4 — The Gandhi cap

Fact	Detail
Origin	"Some time after his return to India from South Africa in 1915 , Gandhi transformed the KASHMIRI CAP that he sometimes used into a CHEAP WHITE COTTON KHADI CAP "
★ His own use	"For two years from 1919 he himself wore the cap, and THEN GAVE IT UP — but by this time it had become PART OF THE NATIONALIST UNIFORM and even A SYMBOL OF DEFIANCE "
★★ Banned	"The GWALIOR state tried to PROHIBIT its use in 1921 during the non-cooperation movement"
★★ Shared	"During the KHILAFAT movement the cap was worn by LARGE NUMBERS OF HINDUS AND MUSLIMS "
★★★ The Santhals, 1922	"A group of Santhals who attacked the police in 1922 in Bengal demanding the release of Santhal prisoners BELIEVED THAT THE GANDHI CAP WOULD PROTECT THEM FROM BULLETS: THREE OF THEM DIED as a result "
The price of wearing it	"Large numbers of nationalists defiantly wore the Gandhi cap and were even BEATEN OR ARRESTED for doing so"
★★ The fez	*"With the rise of the Khilafat movement in the post-First World War years, the FEZ , a tasselled TURKISH cap, became a SIGN OF ANTI-COLONIALISM in India. Though many Hindus — as in Hyderabad for instance — also wore the fez, IT SOON BECAME IDENTIFIED SOLELY WITH MUSLIMS ."*

★★★★ Two things in this box are worth real thought. First, **Gandhi stopped wearing the cap in 1921** and it became more powerful, not less — a symbol that has entered general circulation **no longer depends on its author**, which is both the point of symbols and their danger. Second, **the Santhal detail belongs in any answer about how mass movements actually travel**. Peasants and adivasis did not receive Gandhi's ideas as a philosophy of non-violence and self-reliance; **they received a cap and invested it with protective power, and three of them died of the belief**. ★ (You met this exact phenomenon in **Class 8 Ch.8** — the peasants of Pratapgarh crediting Gandhiji with their own achievements, and rumours of his miraculous powers.) **What a leader intends and what a movement receives are never the same thing**, and the honest historian records both. ★★★ **And the fez's trajectory is a small tragedy worth noting**: a cap that in the Khilafat years was a **shared anti-colonial sign worn by Hindus and Muslims alike** ended up "*identified SOLELY with Muslims*." Symbols of unity can harden into markers of separation — which is the whole arc of 1920 to 1947 in one hat.

🚫 5.3 Not all could wear khadi — ★★★★★ the section that makes this chapter serious

*"Mahatma Gandhi's dream was to **CLOTHE THE WHOLE NATION IN KHADI**. He felt khadi would be a means of **ERASING DIFFERENCE BETWEEN RELIGIONS, CLASSES, ETC.** But was it easy for others to follow in his footsteps? **Was such a unity possible? Not many could take to the single peasant loincloth as he had. NOR DID ALL WANT TO.**"*

Who	Response
★★ Motilal Nehru	*"a successful barrister from Allahabad , gave up his expensive Western-style suits and adopted the Indian DHOTI AND KURTA . BUT THESE WERE NOT MADE OF COARSE CLOTH. "*
★★★★ Babasaheb Ambedkar and Dalits	*"Those who had been DEPRIVED BY CASTE NORMS FOR CENTURIES were ATTRACTED TO WESTERN DRESS STYLES . Therefore, unlike Mahatma Gandhi, other nationalists such as BABASAHEB AMBEDKAR NEVER GAVE UP THE WESTERN-STYLE SUIT . Many Dalits began in the EARLY 1910s to wear THREE-PIECE SUITS , and SHOES AND SOCKS on all public occasions, AS A POLITICAL STATEMENT OF SELF-RESPECT. "*
★★★ A woman from Maharashtra, writing to Gandhi in 1928	*"A year ago, I heard you speaking on the extreme necessity of every one of us wearing khadi and thereupon decided to adopt it. BUT WE ARE POOR PEOPLE. MY HUSBAND SAYS KHADI IS COSTLY. Belonging as I do to Maharashtra, I wear a sari NINE YARDS long... (and) THE ELDERS WILL NOT HEAR OF A REDUCTION (to six yards). "*
★★ Sarojini Naidu and Kamala Nehru	"wore COLOURED SARIS WITH DESIGNS , instead of coarse, white homespun"

★★★★★ The Ambedkar point is the most important single idea in Part B, and you must be able to state it without caricature. Gandhi's khadi took **the dress of the poorest** and made it a badge of honour — a powerful move **for someone choosing to descend**. But for a Dalit, **poverty and coarse cloth were not a choice; they were the imposed uniform of humiliation**, alongside the prohibitions on shoes, umbrellas and gold that you met in the Shanar story. **Voluntary simplicity is a privilege of those who could have had otherwise**. So the **three-piece suit, shoes and socks** were not aping the West — they were the **most direct possible refusal of a caste dress code**, and "*a political statement of self-respect*" is NCERT's own phrase for it. 🌀 **State it as a genuine disagreement between two nationalists about what dignity requires** — Gandhi seeking dignity in **identification with the poorest**, Ambedkar seeking it in **the visible refusal of imposed inferiority** — and not as one being right. **That is the answer that gets the marks.**

★★★ And the woman's letter deserves its own sentence, because it names **THREE** separate obstacles in four lines: khadi was **too expensive** for a poor household; her **husband** decided the family budget; and **the elders** would not permit even a reduction from nine yards to six. **She was willing. She was blocked by cost, by patriarchy within the home, and by custom** — and a national call to wear khadi had no answer to any of the three. **This is why "not all could wear khadi" is not a footnote but the chapter's conclusion.**

🔍 Part B — the conclusion

★★★ *"Changes in styles of clothing are thus linked up with **SHIFTS IN CULTURAL TASTES AND NOTIONS OF BEAUTY**, with **CHANGES WITHIN THE ECONOMY AND SOCIETY**, and with **ISSUES OF SOCIAL AND POLITICAL CONFLICT**. So when we see clothing styles alter we need to ask: **why do these changes take place? What do they tell us about society and its history? What can they tell us about changes in tastes and technologies, markets and industries?**"*

● Prelims traps — Part A

Trap	The truth
"Captain Swing led the 1830 riots"	★★ "Captain Swing was a MYTHIC NAME used in these letters" — there was no such person
"The Swing riots were in northern England"	Southern England; about 387 threshing machines broken; 1,976 tried, 9 hanged, 505 transported (over 450 to Australia), 644 imprisoned
"16th-century enclosures were for grain"	★★ 16th century = WOOL (world wool prices rose). Post-1750 = GRAIN
"Parliament opposed enclosure"	★★ It passed 4,000 Acts legalising enclosures. 6 million acres enclosed between 1750 and 1850. Early enclosures had no state or church backing
"England's grain output rose through new technology"	★★★ "NOT by any radical innovations in agricultural technology, but by bringing NEW LANDS under cultivation"
"Turnip and clover were adopted because farmers knew about nitrogen"	★★ Adopted from about the 1660s because they observed it worked; "later findings showed" the nitrogen effect
"England was self-sufficient in food in 1868"	★ It produced about 80% of what it consumed
"US settlers reached the Great Plains by 1820"	★★ Appalachian plateau by the first decade of the 1800s (over 700,000 by 1800), Mississippi valley 1820–1850, Great Plains only after the 1860s
"McCormick invented the tractor"	★★ Cyrus McCormick invented the mechanical REAPER in 1831 — cutting in a day what 5 men with cradles / 16 men with sickles could
"US wheat acreage rose from 45 to 74 million acres over 20 years"	★★ 1910 → 1919, i.e. nine years — a 65% increase
"The Dust Bowl was caused purely by drought"	★★★★ "ordinary duststorms became black blizzards ONLY BECAUSE the entire landscape had been ploughed over, stripped of all grass". Black blizzards 7,000–8,000 feet high
"Britain paid for Chinese tea in manufactured goods"	★★★ England produced nothing easily saleable in China; tea was bought with silver/bullion, and opium was found to stop the outflow
"Opium was legal in China"	★★ The Emperor had FORBIDDEN production and sale except for medicinal purposes; Western merchants ran an illegal trade from the mid-18th century
"Lin Ze-xu burnt 11,000 crates"	★★ He arrested 1,600 men, confiscated 11,000 POUNDS, and burnt 20,000 CRATES
"India exported 50,000 chests of opium in 1767"	★★ Before 1767, no more than 500 chests; trebled within four years; about 50,000 chests by 1870
"Peasants grew opium willingly for good money"	★★★ Four reasons against: best land needed (displacing pulses), high rent on that land, delicate and time-consuming crop, very low government price
"The opium monopoly was established in 1820"	★★ 1773
"Government opium revenue came from Chinese buyers"	★★★★ "THIS DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THE BUYING AND SELLING PRICE WAS THE GOVERNMENT'S OPIUM REVENUE" — i.e. from underpaying the Indian cultivator
"Pykars were government agents"	★ Travelling traders who offered peasants HIGHER prices; the headmen who passed on the advances were the mahato

● Prelims traps — Part B

Trap	The truth
"Sumptuary laws only enforced social hierarchy"	★ ★ ★ Some protected home production — the 16th-century English woollen-cap law , in force 26 years , applying to everyone over six except those of high position, on Sundays and holy days
"French sumptuary laws began in 1789"	★ ★ From about 1294 UNTIL 1789 — the Revolution ended them
"After the Revolution everyone dressed alike"	★ ★ " Differences in EARNING, rather than sumptuary laws, now defined what the rich and poor could wear "
"Corsets were adopted only by adult women"	★ From childhood girls were laced into STAYS ; corsets when slightly older
"Bloomers were invented in England"	★ ★ Mrs Amelia Bloomer, an AMERICAN . The Rational Dress Society was English, started 1881 , and " did not achieve significant results "
"Stanton led the American Woman Suffrage Association"	★ Mrs Stanton — National Woman Suffrage Association; Lucy Stone — American Woman Suffrage Association; both campaigned in the 1870s
"Skirts shortened in the 1870s"	★ ★ Clothes were ankle length until 1914 (as since the 13th century); by 1915 the hemline rose to mid-calf . Over 700,000 British women in ammunition factories by 1917
"The Shanar revolt was in Madras Presidency"	★ ★ The princely state of TRAVANCORE . May 1822 attacks; 1829 proclamation ordering them to abstain from covering ; slavery abolished 1855 ; October 1859 riots ; then the second proclamation
"The 1859 proclamation gave Shanar women full equality of dress"	★ ★ ★ ★ It permitted covering " <i>in any manner whatever</i> , BUT NOT LIKE THE WOMEN OF HIGH CASTE "
"Shanars were weavers"	★ Toddy tappers , also called Nadars , working under Nair landlords
"Europeans were encouraged to wear Indian dress"	★ ★ In 1830 Europeans were FORBIDDEN Indian clothes at official functions, " <i>so that the cultural identity of the white masters was not undermined</i> "
"All Indians had to remove shoes in government buildings"	★ ★ ★ Under Dalhousie , yes — " only those who wore EUROPEAN CLOTHES were exempted "
"Manockjee refused to remove his turban"	★ ★ The reverse — he said he would have removed the turban , but refused on the shoes . Surat Fouzdaree Adawlut, 1862
"Rabindranath proposed combining Indian and European dress"	★ ★ ★ He proposed combining HINDU AND MUSLIM dress — hence the chapkan
"The Brahmika sari was designed by Rabindranath"	★ ★ Jnanadanandini Devi , wife of Satyendranath Tagore (first Indian in the ICS), adapting the Parsi style, late 1870s
"Gandhi adopted the short dhoti in 1915"	★ ★ ★ 1915 = Kathiawadi peasant dress; 1921 = the short dhoti (announced 22 September 1921). 1913 Durban = lungi and kurta, head shaved . 1888 London = Western suit
"Gandhi adopted the robes of the Indian ascetic"	★ ★ ★ He consciously REJECTED them for the dress of the poorest Indian
"Gandhi wore the Gandhi cap all his life"	★ ★ He wore it for two years from 1919, then gave it up — by then it was already the nationalist uniform
"Ambedkar adopted khadi"	★ ★ ★ He never gave up the Western-style suit ; Dalits wore three-piece suits, shoes and socks from the early 1910s as " <i>a political statement of self-respect</i> "
"Motilal Nehru adopted coarse khadi"	★ He adopted dhoti and kurta — " but these were NOT made of coarse cloth "

● Mains angles

- ★★★★★ "Explain what the open field system meant to rural people in eighteenth-century England" (NCERT asks it from three viewpoints — write it as three short paragraphs): **the rich farmer** (chained, unable to innovate or invest — Middleton's "horse in team"); **the labourer** (the commons as fuel, food, pasture and famine insurance; year-round board at the master's table); **the peasant woman** (cow-keeping, firewood, gleanings, berries — *her* contribution to household income, destroyed first).
- ★★★★★ "Explain the factors which led to enclosures in England." — Wool prices (16th c) → then population **7m** → **21m** → **30m**, urbanisation, rising grain prices, **war with France cutting European imports**, landowner pressure on Parliament, **4,000 Acts**, **6 million acres**.
- ★★★★★ "Why were threshing machines opposed by the poor? Who was Captain Swing?"
- ★★★★★ "What lessons can we draw from the conversion of the American countryside from a bread basket to a dust bowl?" — *the single best GS3 question in this file*. Frontier method (move on when soil exhausts) applied where there was no more frontier; monoculture on a grassland; mechanisation removing the sod; drought as **trigger not cause**; "*they had to respect the ecological conditions of each region*"; and the parallel with the **Maasai drought of 1933–34** in Ch.5.
- ★★★★★ "What were the advantages and disadvantages of mechanical harvesting in the USA?" — Advantage: four men, 2,000–4,000 acres a season; the wartime wheat boom. Disadvantage: **debt on a fixed liability against variable income**, mechanisation destroying the fallback of wage labour, farms deserted, and the surplus that produced the **Great Agrarian Depression**.
- ★★★★★ "Why did the British insist on farmers growing opium, and why were Indian farmers reluctant?" — The tea deficit and the silver drain; the triangular trade; the state's revenue = **the buying–selling price gap**. Then the four reluctances, and the **system of advances** that overrode them.
- ★★★★★ "Some gained, others lost." Compare the fate of rural people in England, the USA and India under modern agriculture. — *This is the chapter's own organising question; the winners/losers table is the answer.*
- ★★★★★ "What were the sumptuary laws in France, and what replaced them?"
- ★★★★★ "Suggest reasons why women in nineteenth-century India were obliged to continue wearing traditional Indian dress even when men switched over to Western clothing. What does this show about the position of women in society?" (NCERT's own question — and a first-rate Indian Society answer.) Men's dress was governed by **the workplace**, which was colonial and Western; women's by **the home and the community**, which was where "tradition" was to be preserved. Women were made **the custodians of cultural identity** precisely because they were excluded from the public sphere where change was happening — so a man could compartmentalise (Reaction Three) while a woman could not. Use the **Kerala blouse source** (the mother with the coconut branch), the **Bengal source** on "shameless attire", the **nine-yard sari letter of 1928**, and the ★ recurring line "*it was MEN rather than WOMEN who affected the new dress styles.*"
- ★★★★★ "Churchill described Gandhi as a 'seditious Middle Temple lawyer' now 'posing as a half naked fakir'. What provoked such a comment and what does it tell you about the symbolic strength of Gandhi's dress?" (NCERT's own question — and the best one in Part B.)
- ★★★★★ "Why did Gandhi's dream of clothing the nation in khadi appeal only to some sections of Indians?" — **Cost** (khadi was coarser, dearer, harder to get); **caste** (Ambedkar and the Dalit suit — voluntary simplicity is a privilege); **patriarchy and custom within the home** (the 1928 letter); **regional dress practice** (nine yards, and the four regions that kept their own sari); and the **partial adoption** of the elite (Motilal's fine dhoti, Sarojini Naidu's coloured saris).
- ★★★★★ **Dress as an instrument of colonial hierarchy.** — The 1830 ban on Europeans in Indian dress; **shoe respect** and the European-clothes exemption; the turban/hat collision; the **1862 Surat case**.
- ★★★★★ **The Shanar revolt as an early assertion of caste dignity.** — "*These codes had the force of law*"; the 1822 attacks; the refusal of free labour alongside the dress change; the two proclamations and what

"but not like the women of high caste" concedes and withholds.

Cross-links to build now

- **Ch.1 of this book** — *sans-culottes*, the red cap, the tricolour: Part B §1 is a **direct continuation**.
 - **Ch.2** — the **US wheat boom during WWI** exists because **Russian supplies were cut off**; that is Ch.2's bread crisis seen from the other end.
 - **Ch.4 & Ch.5** — the **commons**, the annual reallocation of strips, and pastoral rotation are **three risk-pooling institutions** dismantled as disorder; the Dust Bowl and the Maasai drought are **two manufactured disasters**.
 - **Class 8 Ch.2** — Plassey, the Company's revenue logic, the decline of Indian textiles.
 - **☆☆☆ Class 8 Ch.3** — **indigo**: the *satta*, the advances, the demand for the best land, the ryots' resistance. **Opium and indigo are the same machine running on two crops.**
 - **Class 8 Ch.7** — Women, Caste and Reform: the Shanar revolt belongs here.
 - **Class 8 Ch.8** — Swadeshi, Non-Cooperation, the Round Table Conference, and the peasants of Pratapgarh who credited Gandhiji with miraculous powers — the same phenomenon as the Santhals and the bulletproof cap.
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Glossary

Term	Meaning
Enclosure	The division and fencing of open fields and common land into privately owned blocks
Commons	Land all villagers could use — pasture, fuelwood, fruit, fish, rabbit
Gleaning	Gathering the stalks left on the fields after the crops were cut
Captain Swing	The mythic name signed on threatening letters during the 1830–32 riots
Threshing machine	The machine that separated grain from the stalk — and the target of the riots
Reaper	The mechanical harvester invented by Cyrus McCormick, 1831
Dust Bowl	The southern plains after the sod was broken — source of the black blizzards of the 1930s
Black blizzard	A duststorm often 7,000–8,000 feet high
Manchus	The Confucian rulers of China, suspicious of foreign merchants
Chest / maund	An opium chest = two maunds ; a maund = 40 seers ; a seer is a little under a kg
Mahato	The village headman through whom government opium advances reached cultivators
Pykars	Travelling traders who offered peasants higher prices than the government agents
Sumptuary laws	Laws regulating what social inferiors could wear, eat, drink and hunt — France, c. 1294–1789
Cockade	Cap, usually worn on one side
Ermine	A type of fur, reserved for royalty
Stays	Support in a woman's dress to hold the body straight
Corset	A closely fitting, stiff inner bodice giving shape and support to the figure
Busk	A strip of wood, whalebone or steel stiffening the front of a corset
Pabulum	Anything essential to maintain life and growth
Suffrage	The right to vote
Bloomers / rationals / knickerbockers	The ankle-length trousers under a loose tunic launched by Amelia Bloomer
Chintz	Cotton cloth printed with designs and flowers — from the Hindi chint
Phenta	The hat adopted by wealthy Parsis with Western-style dress
Shanars / Nadars	The toddy-tapper community of southern Travancore at the centre of the dress revolt
Chapkan	The long buttoned coat Rabindranath Tagore proposed as a national dress for men
Brahmika sari	The Parsi-style sari pinned at the left shoulder with a blouse and shoes, popularised by Jnanadanandini Devi
Peta	The Mysore turban , edged with gold lace
Khadi	Coarse cloth made from homespun yarn — to Gandhi a sign of purity, simplicity and poverty
Fez	The tasselled Turkish cap that became an anti-colonial sign during the Khilafat movement

60-Second Recap

Part A — Peasants and Farmers

1. **England before enclosure:** open countryside, **strips allocated annually at a public meeting**, deliberately **mixed in quality and scattered** so everyone had good and bad land; beyond them **the**

commons — pasture, fuelwood, berries, fish, rabbit. ★ *"For the poor, the common land was **essential** for survival."*

2. ★ **16th-century enclosures were for WOOL** (world prices rose), driven by **individual landlords, not backed by state or church**. **Post-1750 enclosures were for GRAIN** — and **Parliament passed 4,000 Acts; 6 million acres enclosed 1750–1850**.
3. **Why: population 7m (1750) → 21m (1850) → 30m (1900)**; urbanisation; **war with France** cutting European grain imports and sending prices skyrocketing; and landowners **pressurising Parliament**.
4. ★ ★ **Unlike every earlier period, grain production kept pace with population — 80% of England's food was home-grown in 1868** — and this came **not from new technology but from new land**. The one improvement, **turnip and clover from the 1660s**, was adopted by observation; **the nitrogen explanation came much later**.
5. ★ ★ **For the poor: no firewood, no grazing, no berries, no small game, no gleaning** — *"everything had a price which the poor could not afford."* Displaced from the **Midlands** to the southern counties; and **by 1800 the practice of living with the landowner and eating at his table had ended** — wages, harvest-time only, **no work for most of the year**.
6. ★ ★ **Captain Swing, 1830–32: a mythic name on threatening letters; 387 threshing machines broken** in southern England; **1,976 tried, 9 hanged, 505 transported (450+ to Australia), 644 jailed**. The machines were bought during the **Napoleonic Wars** and became a hate-object after them, when **soldiers returned, European grain flowed in, prices fell and an Agricultural Depression set in**.
7. **The USA: 800 million acres of forest, 600 million of grassland**; settlement confined to the eastern coastal strip till the **1780s**. **Over 700,000 settlers on the Appalachian plateau by 1800**; a government policy after 1800 of **driving American Indians west**, with wars, massacres and forced treaties; **Mississippi valley 1820–50; the Great Plains only after the 1860s**.
8. ★ **Wheat: railways, urban growth, and then WWI** — *"Plant more wheat, wheat will win the war"* — took acreage from **45 million (1910) to 74 million (1919), up 65%; wheat barons held 2,000–3,000 acres each**.
9. ★ **Technology: 12-foot ploughs on six yokes**, then tractors and disk ploughs; **McCormick's reaper, 1831**; combined harvesters cutting **500 acres in two weeks; four men, 2,000–4,000 acres a season**.
10. ★ ★ **For small farmers the machines meant debt** — bank loans against high prices — then **surplus, collapsing prices, and the Great Agrarian Depression of the 1930s**.
11. ★ ★ ★ **The Dust Bowl: black blizzards 7,000–8,000 ft high**, cattle suffocated, rivers coated till the fish died, machines destroyed. Drought was the trigger, but *"ordinary duststorms became black blizzards **ONLY BECAUSE** the entire landscape had been ploughed over, stripped of all grass that held it together."* ★ *"After the 1930s, they realized that they had to **respect the ecological conditions of each region**."*
12. ★ ★ **Opium: tea imports 15m lb (1785) → 30m+ lb (1830); the Company's profits depended on tea; England produced nothing saleable in China**; the **Manchus** refused foreign goods; so tea was bought with **silver**, and opium was found to stop the drain. Illegal trade from the **mid-18th century: 10,000 crates a year by the early 1820s, over 35,000 fifteen years later; 4 million smokers by Lin's estimate, 12 million** by a British doctor's.
13. ★ ★ **Lin Ze-xu, 1839: arrested 1,600, confiscated 11,000 lb, burnt 20,000 crates, closed Canton** — **Britain declared war, and the treaties legalised opium and opened China**. His letter to Queen Victoria: *"Since it is not permitted to do harm to your own country, then even less should you let it be passed on to the harm of other countries."*
14. ★ ★ **In India: under 500 chests before 1767 → trebled in four years → about 50,000 chests by 1870**. Peasants resisted for **four reasons** — poppy needed the best land (displacing **pulses**), rent on that land was high, the crop was **delicate and time-consuming**, and the price was **too low to be profitable**.
15. ★ ★ ★ **The system of advances: government agents → headmen (mahato) → poor peasants, who by taking the loan lost the choice of crop, the choice of buyer and the choice of price**. The government

refused to raise the price because ★ *"the difference between the buying and selling price was the government's opium revenue."* Peasants refused advances, gave up poppy around Benaras for sugarcane and potatoes, and sold to pykars. The monopoly dated from 1773; by the 1820s production was shifting to the princely states, and the British ordered agents to confiscate opium and destroy the crops. The Allahabad agent, 1833: *"the cultivation of the poppy is considered a curse by the people and only by undue authority is it upheld."*

Part B — Clothing

16. ★★ **Sumptuary laws**, France c. 1294–1789: controlled what social inferiors could wear, eat, drink and hunt; clothing regulated by rank as well as income; only royalty could wear ermine, fur, silk, velvet and brocade. ★ But some sumptuary laws protected home industry — England's woollen-cap law, everyone over six except the high-born, on Sundays and holy days, in force 26 years, *"very useful in building up the English woollen industry."*
17. **The French Revolution ended them: sans-culottes**, loose comfortable clothing, blue-white-red, the red cap of liberty, the cockade — *"the simplicity of clothing was meant to express the idea of equality."* ★ Afterwards, *"differences in earning, rather than sumptuary laws, now defined what the rich and poor could wear."*
18. ★★ **The Victorian corset**: girls laced into stays from childhood, then corsets; the ideal woman was frail, docile and able to bear pain. It caused restricted growth, hampered circulation, bent spines, fainting — and then corsets became necessary to hold up the weakened spine. Mary Somerville prepared her lessons in a steel frame; the Registrar General (1857) compared tight lacing to strangulation.
19. ★★ **Women divided**. Many believed the ideal — *"in the air they breathed."* Others campaigned: from the 1830s alongside suffrage; Amelia Bloomer's tunics over trousers (bloomers, rationals, knickerbockers); Stanton's National and Lucy Stone's American Woman Suffrage Associations in the 1870s; the English Rational Dress Society, 1881. ★ They faced ridicule and largely failed — *"it was the First World War that brought about radical changes."*
20. ★ **Materials and war: Indian chintzes after 1600** enlarged European wardrobes; the Industrial Revolution reversed the trade; artificial fibres came in the early 20th century. Ankle-length since the 13th century until 1914; mid-calf by 1915. Over 700,000 British women in ammunition factories by 1917, in blouse-and-trousers then khaki overalls; sober colours; trousers; and short hair.
21. ★★ **Three Indian reactions: adopt** (wealthy Parsis with the phenta; Dalit Christian converts, who found it liberating); **reject** (the Bengali Babu cartoons, Gaganendranath Tagore's *"Modern Patriot"*); **compartmentalise** (Bengali bureaucrats; Poona policemen removing trousers in the street).
22. ★★★ **The Shanar (Nadar) revolt**: toddy tappers under Nair landlords in Travancore, barred from umbrellas, shoes, gold, and from covering the upper body. Converts began wearing blouses in the 1820s; attacked in May 1822; the 1829 proclamation ordered them to abstain from covering; slavery abolished 1855 heightened upper-caste anxiety; October 1859 riots, houses looted and chapels burned; then the second proclamation permitting cover *"in any manner whatever, but not like the women of high caste."*
23. ★★ **Colonial dress codes**: the turban signified respectability and could not be removed at will, while the hat had to be; 1830 — Europeans forbidden Indian clothes at official functions; under Dalhousie, shoe respect in all government institutions, ★ *"only those who wore European clothes were exempted"*; and Manockjee Cowasjee Entee's 1862 refusal at the Surat Fouzdaree Adawlut — willing to remove his turban, not his shoes.
24. ★★ **The national dress**: the Tagores from the 1870s; Rabindranath proposed combining HINDU AND MUSLIM dress — the chapkan; Jnanadanandini Devi brought the Parsi drape back from Bombay and created the Brahmika sari. The pan-Indian project did not fully succeed.

25. ★ ★ **Swadeshi:** India made **one-fourth of the world's manufactured goods** in the 17th century and had **a million weavers in Bengal** in the mid-18th; then the Industrial Revolution, and ★ *"political control helped the British in **two ways**"* — forced cropping and cheap manufactures — ruining **Murshidabad, Machilipatnam and Surat**. After **Curzon's 1905 partition**, boycott, **khadi as patriotic duty**, shell bangles for glass. ★ **But it appealed mainly to the upper castes and classes, and after 15 years many returned to European dress.**
26. ★ ★ ★ **Gandhi: Western suit in London, 1888**, *"so that he would not be laughed at"*; Western clothes as a **Johannesburg lawyer**; **lungi and kurta with shaved head, Durban 1913**; **Kathiawadi peasant dress on returning in 1915**; **the short dhoti from 22 September 1921** — announced as an **experiment for a month or two**, kept for life. ★ *"I adopt the change because **I have always hesitated to advise anything I may not be prepared to follow.**"* He **rejected the ascetic's robe for the dress of the poorest Indian**, and wore the dhoti before **George V in 1931** — *"the King had enough on for both of us."*
27. ★ ★ **The Gandhi cap:** made from a Kashmiri cap after **1915**, worn by him **only 1919–21**, then **prohibited by Gwalior in 1921**, shared by Hindus and Muslims during **Khilafat**; **Santhals in 1922 believed it would stop bullets and three died**. The **fez**, an anti-colonial sign in the Khilafat years, **later came to be identified solely with Muslims.**
28. ★ ★ ★ **Not all could wear khadi: Motilal Nehru** took the dhoti and kurta **but not coarse cloth**; **Sarojini Naidu and Kamala Nehru** wore coloured saris; a Maharashtrian woman wrote in **1928** that **khadi was costly**, her husband said so, and **the elders would not reduce a nine-yard sari to six**; and ★ **Ambedkar never gave up the Western suit** — Dalits had worn **three-piece suits, shoes and socks since the early 1910s** *"as a political statement of self-respect."*

Test Yourself

Prelims style

- The sixteenth-century English enclosures and those after 1750 differed chiefly in that — *the earlier ones promoted **sheep farming for wool**, the later ones **grain production**; and the later ones were **legalised by 4,000 Acts of Parliament.***
- Consider: (i) England's grain output rose after 1780 because of radical new farm technology. (ii) Turnip and clover were adopted from the 1660s. (iii) Parliament passed 4,000 Acts legalising enclosures. — **(ii) and (iii) only.** *The increase came from **bringing new land under cultivation.***
- Cyrus McCormick is associated with — *the **mechanical reaper, 1831**, which cut in one day as much as **five men with cradles and sixteen with sickles.***
- The black blizzards of the 1930s became possible because — *the **entire landscape had been ploughed over and stripped of the grass that held the soil together**; drought alone would have produced ordinary duststorms.*
- The East India Company's opium revenue consisted of — *the **difference between the low price paid to the Indian cultivator and the high price charged to opium agents in Calcutta.***
- Match: *mahato / pykars / maund.* — **mahato = village headman who passed on the advances; pykars = travelling traders offering higher prices; maund = 40 seers, and an opium chest was two maunds.**
- Sumptuary laws in France were in force — *from about **1294 until the Revolution of 1789**, regulating clothing **by social rank as well as income.***

8. The 1859 Travancore proclamation permitted Shanar women to cover their upper bodies — *"in any manner whatever, but not like the women of high caste."*
9. Under Lord Dalhousie's "shoe respect" rule, the exemption applied to — ***those who wore European clothes.***
10. The Brahmika sari was popularised by — ***Jnanadanandini Devi, wife of Satyendranath Tagore, adapting the Parsi style of draping, in the late 1870s.***
11. Gandhi adopted the short dhoti in — ***1921 (announced 22 September).*** (1913 Durban = ***lungi and kurta***; 1915 = ***Kathiawadi peasant dress.***)

Mains style

12. Explain briefly what the open field system meant to rural people in eighteenth-century England, from the point of view of a rich farmer, a labourer and a peasant woman. **(250 words)** ★
13. Explain the factors which led to the enclosures in England, and their consequences for the poor. **(250 words)** ★
14. What lessons can we draw from the conversion of the countryside in the USA from a bread basket to a dust bowl? **(250 words)** ★ — *GS3 crossover*
15. What were the advantages and disadvantages of the use of mechanical harvesting machines in the USA? **(150 words)**
16. Why did the British insist on Indian farmers growing opium, and why were the farmers reluctant? **(250 words)** ★
17. *"Some gained, others lost."* Compare the impact of modern agriculture on rural people in England, the USA and colonial India. **(250 words)**
18. What were the sumptuary laws in France, and what replaced them after 1789? **(150 words)**
19. Suggest reasons why women in nineteenth-century India were obliged to continue wearing traditional dress even when men switched over to Western clothing. What does this show about the position of women in society? **(250 words)** ★
20. Winston Churchill described Gandhi as a *"seditious Middle Temple lawyer"* now *"posing as a half naked fakir."* What provoked such a comment, and what does it tell you about the symbolic strength of Gandhi's dress? **(250 words)** ★
21. Why did Mahatma Gandhi's dream of clothing the nation in khadi appeal only to some sections of Indians? **(250 words)** ★
22. Discuss the Shanar revolt of 1822–1859 as an early assertion of caste dignity. **(250 words)** ★

Self-check (out loud, no notes):

- Explain the strip-allocation rule and why the scattering was deliberate.
- Distinguish the two waves of enclosure by purpose, date and backer.
- Explain how England fed a quadrupled population without new technology.
- Say who Captain Swing was and give the punishment figures.
- Explain the Dust Bowl in two halves — natural and man-made.
- Draw the tea–silver–opium triangle and explain each arrow.
- Give the four reasons peasants refused poppy, and explain what the advance bought.
- Define sumptuary laws and give both their purposes.
- Explain how the corset manufactured the frailty it claimed to describe.

- Give the five dates of the Shanar revolt and quote the 1859 clause.
- Trace Gandhi's dress from 1888 to 1921 and say what each change argued.
- State the Ambedkar objection to khadi fairly.

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